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*First published by Sanatan Prakashan Mandir, the
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Little Modi, Great Modi

By Mahendraditya Pandey and Chetanya
Pandey

Dedicated to our mother

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Introduction

Life is an experimental experience which is subtle to experience and open to its traits. It can be defined as a path which is laid with trees of action and fruits of inspiration.

Every life is a varied path with its own fruit of inspiration. Ours is a blossoming one. The people of India have a blossoming one - in the divine form of Narendra Damodardas Modi.

This is the story of that fruit of inspiration, although in refined and cultivated terms it is not a story but a legend, a legend immortal.

Every human is born as a zygote, then he takes the form of an embryo, then a fetus and then a baby. When the baby is born we know not what fate has in store for the baby. Ad libitum does the child work. When he is born he is but externally touched by the mundane world, and as he grows and increases age-wise he peeps into the materialistic world, and as a child he enters it. This world has a history: The history of the immortals. As the child becomes an adult, his deeds define the kind of person he is. Some

children work sincerely, others rest on the bed of mortal sleep. Their actions make them immortal, not their age.

One such being, great de facto, is Narendra Modi. He is great not only ex officio but also because of being a great man - the real, somewhat subtle identity of every male. Ipso facto, his *modus operandi quod est nemine contradicente* is practical and universal. Actually, every second of a priceless life can be detailed. And duly, this shall lead to the existence of thousands of volumes narrating his sky-reaching life.

But, with great effort, this short book has been prepared only to be parallel to a drop in the ocean of his sweet-as-nectar life, highlighting the shallow pot of his vast-like-ocean works. De novo, we would like to pray to the Supreme Personality of Godhead requesting Him to send more people like Narendra Modi to the earth of materialistic people to relieve it of its heavy onus of sins.

Modiji's deeds can't be expressed in these earthly words. Only with a touch of heavenly, ethereal words can the description be made

possible. Still, with our humble knowledge we have put all our efforts into the matter of this book. We pray that the book be at least partially worthy of the subject.

We, Mahendraditya Pandey and Chetanya Pandey, compiled this book when we were both very young. It is only being published many, many years later. Our own experiences also shaped this manuscript. As public speakers and performers who have appeared on literary and public platforms, we encountered many individuals who had participated in or witnessed the political and cultural movements described in these pages. Conversations with such people often revealed additional anecdotes, perspectives and memories that reinforced, supplemented or occasionally expanded upon the accounts we had heard within our own family. These informal recollections contributed to the narrative. We have made improvements very conservatively thus preserving the original manuscript as when we first wrote it and our style of writing.

Any errata be pardoned.

Early Life

Hiding behind the Aanchal of his mother

Narendra Damodardas Modi stepped on the surface of the earth, on the auspicious day of 17 September just two days after the exalted position of the Sun. The year marking the step was 1950, the middle of the twentieth century. The day was like any other day of the month of September in Gujarat. The Sun rose and set. The only variation was the rise of a baby from the womb of its pious mother.

A poor household of the small town - Vadnagar celebrated, with ethereal delight, the birth of a male baby, but, of course, it did not celebrate the birth of a future Prime Minister of a great country like India who would take the country forward to the pinnacle of glory and make it shine.

The 1950 Vadnagar was bereft of electricity and many other such modern apparatus. The citizens led normal lives with no inclination of achieving and accomplishing anything 'big'. They ate, drank and slept and some, or rather, many worked too. The chores were simple,

although important. Vadnagar was but a past epicentre of culture and now it was the focus. The town had been the domain of no less than ten thousand monks who preached Buddhism and non-violence.

North Indians hailed Vadnagar to be the 'Land of banyan trees' as its name suggests in the contemporary language. Vadnagar is a place with great natural beauty and festivity on the occasion of Vada Amavasya observed by the bodies of the town. And, most notably, Vadnagar has given India a great Prime Minister.

Damodardas hailed from a family named Ranachoddas that migrated to Vadnagar to set up a grocery store in the late years of the nineteenth century. At the time of Narendra's birth he was thirty-five years old - in the prime of his youth.

Damodardas tied the nuptial knot with Hiraben who was and is as good as her name. Narendra arrived in the household just after his two elder brothers, the elder one of whom was Soma (aged six) and Amrit who was but four at that time. When Narendra was a baby of two years

he became the brother of a lovely sister named Vasanti. Three years after Vasanti's birth Pahlada was born. The youngest of all the siblings was Pankaj who took birth in 1958.

The Modi family was poorer than many but also richer than many. Supporting a family consisting of eight members was not a piece of cake. It was a herculean task. The dwelling place was not an edifice. It was made up of bricks joined with the aid of mud. There was no belvedere. No one knew, at that time, that the house wasn't the abode of any ordinary mortal but the domain of an extraordinary mortal whose deeds were actually immortal.

Baby Narendra would spurt like any other baby. He was sensitive and gala. When he started having tramps the parents were naturally flabbergasted. His yelps were pleasant and the skepticism got almost erased. He was eloquent and floundering. That was no hallucination. When Narendra would walk fastidiously and then step, thus, becoming slackened, he would rest awhile. The struggle began and it hasn't come to an end till date. Struggle is a dominant part of everyone's life be it human or deity.

We all know that life loses half of its charm if there is no struggle and if there is no risk to be taken. We struggle in our mother's womb. We struggle for breath when we are born. We struggle in babyhood. As we grow up we struggle to fit ourselves into the mundane world. When we grow older we try to attain all the desirable amenities the world could provide. Struggle is the part and parcel of everyone's life including that of animals.

When Narendra would become morose, he would be stimulated. When he would have funk any soothings would but cut no ice. As his age inflated, he became intent. There was no sign of impotence or struggle for latency. He started producing qualms in the realm of his mind which were rarely solved quite soon. Because of the presence of so many children, he might have been muffed but his ways were distinct.

Narendra's glances were furtive.

The family belonged to the Ghanchi guild that comprises traditional producers of vegetable oil. Narendra imbibed the art of religious tolerance from his glorious ancestors. He possessed several Muslim friends in his childhood significantly because of the Muslim colonies being quite near. He observed Muslim and

Hindu festivals with vows of non-violence to both humans and animals.

His sobriquet was 'ND' and apparently the letters were the initials of the words Narendra and Damodardas.

With the passage of time Narendra became a student. The student life of Mr. Prime Minister, who was then Master Narendra Damodardas Modi, is equally interesting. With abundance in nature, the historical legends are somewhat sarcastic. Narendra was an industrious student. The souvenirs of his student life also reflect his obduracy. A well-known incident radiates this sentiment. Once, Narendra denied a class monitor access to his homework. He persistently insisted that the teacher alone had the right to do so.

There are not one or two but infinitely many incidents which portray that he was born to be great. However, every intelligent child of the country doesn't turn up to be its Prime Minister. There, surely, was something more that outlined the demarcation. Not that he was a bookworm. He was a child of spirit and liveliness. The dominating trait in the spirit of young Narendra was stubbornness. For him the truth alone was

true and he was attached to that with unwavering obstinacy. He had profound faith in truth.

The children of his class often considered him to be 'not like the rest of us' in simple words, little did they know that the person in young Narendra had zero 'likes'.

The word 'Narendra' means 'The King of humans'. This spirit of 'kingliness' was an indispensable part of his character since childhood. He held ascetics in great esteem. As Narendra grew, love for asceticism emerged in his mind and soul. It became widely noticeable. In his early life itself he gave up consuming salt, oil and chillies. This great renunciation procured not alone signs of piety but also those of ambition.

Religion is like the water that grants the Indian soil its fecundity. It is the presence of varied religions apart from geographical conditions that makes India a diverse land. The religious diversity of the country makes it exquisitely beautiful and fertile. Religion is the foundation of art and culture which are the rabi and kharif crops growing on the fecund soil. If India is unique, it is because of the religions she

mothers. Later the fifteenth, sixteenth and seventeenth centuries arose a sense of religious intolerance which might have been prevalent also as well. It is present even after the centuries. The thing that has to be attacked bonafide is not the religious diversity but the religious intolerance.

Unity - can it ever exist without diversity? Likewise, peace can't retain its original identity without war because war is its origin. Without diversity, unity shall lose its power, its value and be neglected. In the same manner, we can't appreciate peace without undergoing the tormentations of war and realizing how disastrous it is. So, unity imputes its importance to diversity.

With its diverse minerals, the Indian soil is home to religious ambassadors. With its diverse citizens, the Indian soil is home to multiple religious ideas. Such a great country was the birthplace of Narendrabhai and Narendrabhai was born to make the country greater than the greatest. Child Narendrabhai was a bibliophile. He loved books. He loved reading books. He loved gaining knowledge from the 'knowledgeable' books.

Narendra had his own ways. He was not a follower of 'verbatim ac litteratim'. His 'ways' might have been long but they were accurate and uncommon.

Narendra was devoted to Narendra Nath Dutta (alias Swami Vivekanand). He was respectful to his preceptors and liked the association of sacred souls. He was a philosopher since childhood and loved to talk about such subjects. He also loved the discussions pertaining to such topics. He used to play the game 'Find the good in me'.

'Damodardas' means the eternal helper of 'Damodar', a synonym of the twenty-second incarnation of Lord Vishnu, Shree Krishna. So, in extenso, id est, Narendra Damodardas means the King of humans who is the aide of Bhagwan Shree Krishna. And, as is needless to say, Narendra's religiosity was an evidence of the gracefulness of his graceful name.

Narendra was a 'boy of letters and insight'. He was determined and ambitious. He would do any opus given to him. He would never consider it to be an onus quod erat demonstrandum by his great name.

After coming back home from school, young Narendra would stimulatingly inflate with pleasure and head towards his destination - his father's tea stall. He would serve tea to the railway passengers just as Krishnaji took away the plates of the brahmins and cleaned them at the time of the Rajasuya Yajna being performed by sagacious Yudhishthira. Narendra, in cogent terms, loved the job he was asked to do. All chores had equal importance for him. However, I must say, he couldn't serve biscuits to the passengers because they would be used up for feeding the dogs.

Narendra, without any qualm, deeply loved the country he was born in. Being a great patriot he was absolutely, without fail, devoted to his prestigious country. He believed in self-service and selfless action. This brought in him a sense of self-service to his country and his state as well. All his self-developed ideas were clearly imperceptible. Anyway, one thing surely matters - he was just eight years old when he became a swayamsevak and joined the local branch of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) established by Keshav Baliram Hedgewar. This vividly portrays his sense of

self-service in a large landscape. This vivacious soul had far-reaching thoughts and a unique kingly trait - ambition. However, there are many swayamsevakas who remain at the backstage level. No qualm, that is the most essential sector but convincing the audience is equally significant.

And fate had something else in store for young Narendra.

The Inscrutable Approach Vagrant Narendra

Narendra's family was an amiable one. I am cock-sure that it was a perfect example of an ideal Indian family. Children were 'curbed' with a ferule, so that they may not become pampered. And Narendra's mother was one covered with eclat. She was agreeable and was a woman of ethical pulchritude. She left no stone unturned in bringing up her children well and making them imbibe both simple and intricate values.

She showered affection upon them and also taught them the Indian moral values - the first signs of education. Hiraben was one who proved that the premier teacher of a child is his mother alone. The mother was determined that way; she was a great example of motherhood. Surely enough, there is no need of appreciating her further. The greatness is all rooted in the soil of her son, and it was her spiritual insight that made young Narendra a far-sighted and non-querulous man. Thinkers have truly said - The hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.

And what better evidence could be given than this?

A child is, to a great extent, influenced by his surroundings, the environment, *exempli gratia*, a child living in slums is only expected to stone a poor dog venomously. This is the probability. There could certainly be one with a difference but that one will be one in millions. A little slum dweller might be kind towards animals and may not be infernal. He might not jeopardize the animals but it is not very likely to happen. So, it is an inborn malicious instinct. As for Mr. Prime Minister, his house environment and his state environment were appealing. The culture of Gujarat made him strong-willed and strong-emotioned.

His jauntiness is just one of its results. The sacred environment of Gujarat and the atmosphere of the house shaped young Narendra, a patriot. By nature Narendra was resolute. His poverty was never a hurdle in his spiritual advancement. The holy shrine of Giripur Mahadeva was where he found eternal

peace and there he would chant and recite the name of God with sublime devotion.

He also took his studies grimly. His mind was poised because of the content of broad-mindedness. There was no sign of knavishness in his mind. Narendra had a practical approach towards life. He had the habit of finding multiple ways of solving problems. There was one thing more that brought him out. He detested jabbering. It was a sheer wastage of time for India's future Prime Minister. Serenity was reflected by his face and fanciful were his ways. He was, in a way, insurmountable. He loved discovering novel ways of operating the ironmongery.

His ways were, most likely, vague for the common man but they were reliable and distinct. Tomfoolery enchanted him from a varied point-of-view, not from the childish view. Everything, even as small as a hansom, was a matter to ponder over for peering at Narendra. He couldn't be unnerved by a grotesque thing. Even though his actions were mostly impromptu, they would compel the folk to solve a jigsaw puzzle. Even when he would act precipitately, others would be taken aback as

they couldn't even fancy a young lad doing deeds sumptuous for his age. His formidable ecstasy was incessantly there, and even now it hasn't sallied.

All thanks to his mother who with her stringent state of siege, never let him be convulsive.

Antagonists could hardly stand before the protagonist. His bed might have been tawdry but his character was rich. The deeds of eminent Narendra were so well-scheduled that he would not have to bustle. Ab initio, he had been a great disciplinarian in every walk of his life. He had always been so absorbed in his work that everything else seemed to be sojourn to him. He was not egotistical but sociable. His ways might have sounded weird but they were fruitful.

When he joined the RSS he was good to the confederates. He possessed a taste for impurity and self-service. When the swayamsevaks would coagulate he would listen to the orators with frantic patience. The way the bigwig wrote was spasmodic and dexterous. He would write, only after collating and confirming the annotated text. He was delightfully amenable. Before scoffing, he would thank God for giving him repast to eat and request Him for giving everyone food to eat. He was sharp at taking

notes and also at memory. He always had a blazing inclination in his 'heart so kind' — service to the impecunious and the animals. The desire was surely neither servile nor slavish.

He had clambered these heights even as a young lad. In all these years the wriggling scrambling baby had become a recipient of praise. At the same time, however, he had run the gauntlet.

Now, with all the description if we do an ex ante, we won't be wrong, sure?

Nota bene.

Narendra, with his sincere desire for employing alternatives, was sure to alter the world at the altar of alteration one day. Hiraben observed this. She was sometimes eavesdropping. And fate meant her observation. The child, who was born like any other baby, was entitled to become the leader of the world one day. He knew the way and was born to show the way and go the way. He was born to be a leader in a true sense. He was not fated to lead a usual life. He had been carved with infinite potency and dazzling brilliance. He wasn't born to evade the

sight of the folks but to make an old portmanteau new and glowing. He was born to change the aeon and not to be assaulted by sins. He was born to establish the wreckage again, not to neglect that. He was not meant to lapse from the path of truthfulness but to propagate it. He had been born to unite the multitudinous. He had been born to conquer and not to loiter lazily. He was not born to be a tumultuous loud 'speaker' but one who speaks pursuant to the theory — the revolutionary theory. He wasn't born to be crumpled like paper but to crumple the crumplers of righteousness.

And if such a great being, who was born to make the epoch and who shone like the moon amongst all stars, were left to suck without the knowledge of mundane affairs — the affairs of the world he was to change, what would have happened?

Narendra, a child swayamsevak was taught what it meant to be a volunteer by Laxmanrao Inamdar who was better known as 'Vakil Saheb'. He was, qualmlessly, the sculptor of the political outlook of Narendra.

Obviously, a child who is a student, a child-aide (at the tea stall) and a child-volunteer is sure to be a worldly man tomorrow.

It was 1963 — thirteen years after the birth of the baby who was now well-built both intellectually and physically. Narendra, now, had to seek admission at the local high school. As he left his babyhood and childhood, so did he leave the Vadnagar Primary school No. 1 behind. As he entered teenage, so would he now enter high school. He would now get to read bulky books deprived of illustrations. But it would not be that distasteful or a fag for Narendra, would it be?

However, all that colourful imagination regarding colourless books became colourless as Damodardas, the father of India's would-be Prime Minister, was not interested in that because the Soldier School was far away. There were several reasons for the decision.

But from a side view this enhanced the chance of little Narendra to step outside Vadnagar.

Today when the legal age of marriage for girls is 18 and the marriageable age for males is 21, even the mention of engagement at the age of three is quite unbelievable but then, there are many unbelievable things we have to believe in. And during the time of the late twentieth century, especially during the 1950s and 1960s (before the decades as well), that was something frequent.

3-year-old Narendra was affianced to a girl who belonged to a nearby town. And as her age increased Jashodaben became of nearly marriageable age.

Narendra, all of a sudden, left Vadnagar quite drily (at the age of seventeen — four years after the completion of his studies at the Vadnagar Primary school No. 1) At that time Jashodaben was just fifteen years old. She would just mope about. In this context, Jashodaben was a great sati who never 'remarried' although it was legal. She never asked her parents to search for another 'bridegroom' for her, rather she resolved to pass her life as a schoolteacher and has retired now, still she is hopeful and hopes that her consort will, one day, come back home. She

is a 'perfect' example of an ideal wife, a loving, caring and dutiful wife. She has set an exemplary example for the Indian ladies in the age of Kaliyuga. It hardly happens but it did happen: a wife is as illustrious as her husband. If Narendra Modi exemplifies the life of an ideal man who has stood true to his responsibilities as a citizen, Jashodaben has set a practical example of an ideal Indian lady. The piety, sacrifice and devotion of Indian women makes India great. In this land family relations are deeply rooted.

A seventeen year old teenager has an absolutely different view, far different from the view of adults who are wholly engaged and engrossed in their family life. A child knows only about toys. He might imagine an 'Iron Man' but the fancy of 'Iron-strong India' doesn't fancy him. It is far beyond his reach. However, Narendra was an exceptional case. The old people can spend time in framing the skeleton of the 'Iron-strong India' but they usually don't aspire to make the formidable dream formidable in reality. The only 'working' age-group that is left is teenage which Narendra was presently in. He loved the customs, the traditions and the culture of India

but he also loved something else. Narendra loved debating. It was, since his childhood, his passion. He was a celebrated author and orator. He knew how to express himself through his body language as well during the time of debating. He was eloquent, lucid and fluent. In prone terms he was a public speaker. His speech was not ostentatious but commanding. The gesticulations were appealing and apprehensive. He was not at all tremulous when he spoke. He had all the traits an orator is expected to possess. The possession was remarkable. He was also interested in dramatics.

When Narendra was quitting home his family was naturally crestfallen. It was incredulous for them but the mania was not to be conquered so easily. It had cropped up for a cause and its crony was ambition.

The family members wanted to know the objective of his leaving the house. He respectfully told them he wanted to see the Himalayas.

Narendra was no ordinary teenager, so how could his deeds be fallacious? The occult part is

that he was inclined to receive the blessings of his relatives. The family members, who thought that his exit from home was indecorous, had no better option to opt for. Narendra was resolute, a common trait found in a teenager but he was grim since his childhood which is quite unusual for a child. This 'ineptitude' was ineluctable.

On the occasion of his departure Hiraben prepared a sweet dish called *kansar* which was a good omen. The tilak ceremony was duly performed. It is said to awaken the spiritual third eye. The mark of tilak is considered to be the place of the presence of the troisième eye. This leads to the opening of the closed doors of spirituality signifying success and prosperity quod est, of course, a good omen. This incident artistically and realistically carves the devotion and love Narendra had for his parents. The incident might be confounding but Narendra was doubtlessly a realist who believed more in actions than in fancies. Uncontroversial plans are essential just as a skeleton is valuable for the body, but just devising and scrutinizing plans is not adequate, they also have to be worked out. A person who is capable of both planning and working out the framework is a

true marquis, and Narendra Modi was an example. Indeed, the mulish person knew that a skeleton is useless without flesh, blood et cetera. Narendra knew how to add all these to the skeleton.

Narendra, who revered Indian traditions highly, obediently received the blessings of the kinsfolk but at the same time he also opposed them and was disobedient to them. Narendra was one who obeyed his own orders to make the world orderly. Narendra left his home as a vagabond with no vainglorious speech valedictory only to become one vagrant among many lost to the world which at the same time infuses and defuses such complex arrangement of units including Narendra whose decision was taken to be vacuous. He left without a valet but with something looking like a valise. Many of his relatives considered him to be a vapid vandal who had set off on his own to vanquish himself like a mutt. Really, Narendra had set the Thames on fire. The people set at loggerheads couldn't set him right because he was set on doing what he deemed to do without any emolument. But others thought that he was well set up with his own setback. But the mysterious

man hadn't taken birth to sit on a settee when he had seen a shack as well. He was born to be the protagonist in many a picaresque not because of his physiognomy but because of his being a perspicacious personage. His cherubic chef-d'oeuvre was going to be created. The time of evil would have to peter out. The phantasm and the phantom of the phalanx had to be wiped out by the winsome who appeared to be wishy-washy. He was the will-o'-the-wisp. And the will-o'-the-wisp had got his chance.

After our poster boy had left the house dubiously the doleful and mournful elders began their draconian, downhearted, downbeat and downcast tattle about the dork, dour and doughty person in the domicile. With great dragoon and coercion they lamented. The talk was stultifying and about the 'stropky' supernumerary person who was a supernova. In the sweltering weather they spoke tacitly. The tame tale was wholly about the talisman. How could Hiraben tamper when she was so anxious about the future of her son? Narendra left the house without tarrying. He was outside the house teetering. He overcame the barricades and neglected the base banter. He stepped

outside the abode of bedlam with no bellicose ambition.

Narendra, who was not at all besotted with his house, left his home betwixt pleasure and pain. He wandered for no less than three decades during which he 'didn't ever erect a bivouac'. His decision might have been supposed to be a 'bloomer' but the point is that it was only a supposition. One must accept the fact that the acts of the temporal world of famous people can't be surreptitious.

Three decades is not a short period of time but for a troubadour it is equal to three minutes spent in 'musical silence'.

The trudge made the unadulterated person open to the ulterior world unanimously. The unswerving man saw how unctuous people behaved as if they were unimpeachable. It was like a beautiful upholstery on a broken sofa. It was so virulent!

Narendra 'explored' the entire India. He tarried in different houses with different families. Every kind of food was welcome. It only had to

be VEGETARIAN. The only food he didn't eat was non-vegetarian food. Narendra Modi has always been a stringent vegetarian. This shows that he is not only a philanthropist but also an animal-lover. This is what I consider to be his greatest virtue. A person who doesn't make his stomach the graveyard of animals is profoundly capable of engraving his name on the pages of the History of the world. I staunchly believe that the principle of vegetarianism can heal the world and also inspire us to proceed on the path of vegetarianism.

Narendra set out with very chicken feed money and clothes. The money was the fruit of the assiduous person's great industry. However, Narendra had the power of converting weaknesses into strength. He knew how to make the disadvantageous advantageous and here too he used the same power. He found the lack of money to be a golden chance to learn and follow the practice of not being dependent upon a thing like money. It made him independent in the truest sense. And such independence grants one the prowess to step ahead as then one is not in need of such an object. Ad libitum does one work then. Such

independence, id est, true impunity, makes one rough-and-tough and strong enough to survive under the circumstances. It doesn't allow money to pry into one's work. Independence does not mean freedom from a ruling power alone, it also means freedom from money, ain't it? This is termed practical freedom and for a young man it is a great benefactor. The biggest onus of a man's life who has a family to sustain is income. And if one could live without money it is an extremely great accomplishment — not merely an achievement, as it's just like living without life. The journey of Narendra benefitted him from the very beginning by making him accomplish and achieve practical freedom. It was a great benediction. Narendra, who was in a hand-to-mouth position, first, went to West Bengal, a state in India. He went to the bank of the river Hooghly near Calcutta (now Kolkata). The Summer season had vanquished winter. The year 1968 had succeeded 1967 and was going to be succeeded by 1969. Narendra was now approximately eighteen years old. He was still a teenager but with the duties of an adult placed upon his shoulders. He had never been a part of tittle-tattle and would never be. The to-do in the house on the marriage eve had ceased

to exist long ago. He had no one to depend upon. Independence has its own charms but the fury of isolation is unbearable. Independence and isolation seem to be so similar to each other but it is axiomatic that Man is an independent social animal. However at the same time they are complementary to each other. One can't exercise one's independence when there is no object. That's the bliss of independence when one is all alone, one's bovine valour gets lost and one becomes no better than a booby engaged in bosh imagination. In this way the society of men is comparable with the society of jackals who amass for safety as they are scared of the lion, their predator. Amusingly they can show their valour in front of a weak animal but they are lubbers in front of the lion. So are men. They kill animals for food and coagulate to protect themselves but when a vanquisher jumps into the fray they lick the dust.

But Narendra was the lion among men who was 'not like the rest of them'. He was born to be isolated because his thinking was matchless.

The Belur Math, that's a temple-monastery, is the headquarters of Swami Vivekanand's

mission named Ramakrishna Mission. It is named after the preceptor of the Swami, Shri Ramakrishna who was Paramhansa and a devoted devotee of Goddess Kali.

That was where Narendra went. Swami Madhabanandaji was the then president of the institution. However, unluckily (only to be lucky for him later) things turned out to be different and Narendra came to know that the Matha was stringently a 'postgraduate institution'. Swami Madhabanandaji, whom Narendra met, told him that it was essential for Narendra to complete his systematic college education, only then would he be admitted.

Narendra stayed there for ca or c a week after which he decided to visit the North and went his way.

En route he came across a seer. Narendra, helping-natured as he was, aided the ascetic. The duo spent time 'scrutinizing' spiritualism. Narendra, who was very interested in spiritualism, got all his interstices filled as he got to know a substantial part of spiritualism. He came to know about the 'deeper waters' of

the vast ocean of spiritualism. He revered the anchorite highly. Après un mois, he resumed his journey. As he moved on, Narendra arrived at a monastery. This monastery, too, had been established by Swami Vivekanand. After wandering headlong for a year Narendra came back to his own state. He visited the Ramakrishna Mission in Rajkot which too was associated with Narendra Nath Dutt. Narendra's trip made him 'discover' the vast land. The tour to the Rajkot Ramakrishna Mission shaped Narendra's life. This was the third time he was told to shape a new path. Swami Atmasthanandji told Narendra it would be better if he stopped trying to become a Ramakrishna monk. He also told him that such a monkish life was not the future of Narendra. He told him that such a young man like him had not been built to lead a monkish life. Narendra, having admitted the fact, thanked Swami Atmasthanandji Maharaj gratefully.

Swamiji had foreseen in young Narendra a great being. He saw that he had not been born to lead the life of an ascetic. Could we say Swamiji knew well that he had been born to startle the world with his startling doings and that the saint

knew that the future of Narendra was not simple but complex? Perhaps his conglomerate vision foresaw that Narendra was not born to die as a monk. He was born to create histories. He knew that Narendra had to seek his future alibi. His life was not to be monkish but 'workish'. So thought and said the great Swami. His thoughts and oration welcomed Narendra to a different life, a changed life. All was clear to him like crystal.

Now, Narendra had got a new, unequivocal vision. His old vision had been swept away by the broom of the words of Swamiji. All his qualms regarding his future had disappeared by the wand of the inscrutable words of Swamiji. Narendra, now, knew what he had been born for. He knew how to prove his birth fruitful. That's why, eggheads say that words have the potency of altering one's life. They are like arrows. Once they are shot they can't be taken back. They reach the person — the target. Good words make one aware of one's subtleties. This encourages one to do better. Bad words hurt or encourage one to do better, that depends upon the thinking of the person (the object). The thinking might be mutable. Mysterious words

like those of Swamiji's make one aware of one's talents, God-gifted or eerie prowess and so on.

This was a nice instance which proved that words are like arrows. The words of Swami Atmasthanandji in no way made Narendra's deep devotion to Narendra Nath Dutt (alias Swami Vivekanand) less. He revered the moralist just as before. Narendra was a great follower of Swamiji who inspired people to work. Narendra belonged to the same faith.

It was a fine day. The sun rose marking the initiation of dawn. The sun set too, and this pointed out that dusk had sat on the throne. With respect to this it was the same as before. The sun didn't remain stuck in the sky nor did the moon. So the moon, then, got a chance to rise high and spread its illumination. This put an end to any altercations or bandying that might have arisen during the day. The day, like any other day, did not remain inconclusive although it was transient.

The Ghanchi household welcomed 'something' new. Hiraben was, as usual, depressed. She was waiting with anxiety for the news of her son's

safe arrival. Narendra, pattering as he was, went towards his old sweet home. He stood at the gate somewhat emotionlessly. That was not so elusive. Hiraben entered the front room and asked the oh-so-routine 'Where have you been?' question in Gujarati patois. The reply was 'The Himalayas'. His mother decided to prepare 'Pakawaan' but Narendra only wanted to eat simple viands. Then he left the home. His father was not at home then, and it was not him whom he went out to meet. Confounding? Narendra went to Vakil Saheb. As he prepared to go away, Hiraben, who was 'scrutinizing' and fossicking his bag, saw her photograph in it. If she had become overwhelmed it can't be expressed in flat terms. She never knew how her son had set his hands on the photo. The only thing she knew was that she had never seen her own photo. This incident reflects that Narendra loves his mother not from the bottom of his heart but from the core of his heart.

Narendra stayed, just for a night, with his family. After deux years his family had merely got a glimpse of Narendra, who had grown up to be a fine, young fellow. How time flies by!

Such a short meeting was quite dissatisfactory for the family. Even now he has little contact with his frères, one of whom serves in a lathi-turning factory. One of the rest serves the information department of his home-state. Yet another one is à la tête of the local mercantile businessmen's group in the city of Ahmedabad. They all live separately.

In 2002 Hiraben told a reporter that Modiji loves patriotism more than anything else. She also recounted a story —

Once, when Modiji came across a one-rupee coin on the road he was told to spend the money on himself but despite the suggestion he gave the money to a lassie, a poor man's daughter (though he himself was poor) so that she could purchase books and pencils. See her remarkable memory pertaining to the activities of her son!

She also said that her son always takes bath in cold water.

Temperature doesn't affect her son.

How keenly did Hiraben speak about her beloved son! As Hiraben went down memory lane she recalled the past incidents that had happened long ago. Blessed is the mother who begot a son like Narendra! Blessed is Narendra to have got a mother like Hiraben!

Narendra is used to taking bath in cold water but this in no way has made him cold. He is warm-hearted and 'warmingly' welcoming. He is calm and sincere. He has great aplomb. Scentism can't exist in this matter. His expressions are not chosen but internal. He works deftly and with an aura of eclat. His delivery and speech is staccato. He doesn't snub the slightest matter. When he coagulates his helpers, he listens to them patiently and intently. He does not droop on a side of public disinterest. All this description is scanty. It is just a description of the 'vestiges'. Even though his ways might sound uncanny and dazzling, they are not at all humbugging. Trudging down, it is visible that he has no posterity to aid financially. Why do politicians act like Bengollas? It is because they have their children and they are worried about their future. They

wonder what will become of their children if they don't screw up money for them.

All these ponderables make politicians accumulate money for their 'lineage-comers'. And if they work pursuant to the law, how will they manage all this? This makes them take bribes. They preserve money to suffice for at least a lifetime. This is the incinerator for the combustion of the bribe-cycle of India.

But, ruefully, Narendra Modi doesn't fit in any rubric. He has no one to support (except India, of course) and if he has he doesn't. That makes him evade the path. His path is transparent, not opaque. This path is not followed sporadically and also not transiently. He is a benign personality interested only in the public welfare. His deeds are not ephemeral.

Narendra bid his family cheerio adieu. He went to live and work with an uncle in Ahmedabad. The relative was a local businessman. Ab initio Narendra loved working in the RSS ad-infinitum. Ad hoc, he went to Ahmedabad.

The Turning Point

The 56-inch chest

Having been vacated by Narendra the Ghanchi household became quite morose. Hiraben lived in the same way without her son as fish 'live' outside water. The night for which Narendra sojourned was cheerful and hopeful but the departure of Narendra also led to the departure of pleasure from the home. Not a moment passed when Narendra was not remembered. Recollecting the sweet reminiscences of her sweet son, Hiraben was consoling herself. Prayers to God for his safety were constant. Hiraben's consternation knew no bounds. Every soul prayed for the well-being of Narendra.

The nature of Narendra was held in contempt by Damodardas who thought that his son was off the track. He thought that Narendra cared little about following him. Other such thoughts formed an imperceptible cover of gloom all around. Every aurora began with such thoughts. No oil could massage his brain. That had taxed his patience and Narendra had taxed his brain. Damodardas, with his sixth sense, was sensing

something weird. He was just pondering over the ordinance of fate. He was worried because he knew the inbred and innate traits of Narendra. He knew how nervy he was when it came to ambition. Narendra was always the quarry of his thoughts. He wondered if all that was pure hypothesis. He considered his son to be egotistical and his proclamations were bewitching. He wondered if his son was surrounded by exasperation. It was pretty clear, though, that he won't be malignant or spiteful. An epoch passed as he thought endlessly. He was surely assaulted by such thoughts. They gave him much ado. He would sit deep in contemplation. Not even a momentary lapse from thinking about Narendra would take place. He would wonder if the path his son was walking on was clumsy and ludicrous. The contemplative man's thoughts were multitudinous. His hopes, at least in conformity with his thinking, were all crumpled. He discarded the idea of persuasion. Concussion engulfed him. He thought that his son, who was just a little boy for him, was precipitating. He was unhitched to a particular thought. He minced many of the thoughts with the 'mincer' of the belief that the thing ordained by fate

wouldn't be changed. He entered into a confabulation with himself. It was still quite convulsive. He thought that his son's path was disrupted. And thinking this he became doleful and dolourous. He was in a pensive state. He confined the enmeshing thoughts within himself and tried to furtively mitigate and debilitate his sorrow regarding his dogged son. He placed multiplex thoughts in his petite 'felt' portmanteau. Engaged in the exchange he robbed Peter to pay Paul. He staggered as he thought and thought and thought. He seemed to 'strike his bargain' when he consoled himself. He acted like a haggler then. Such thoughts he clasped. He whisked as he thought. His heart had been stabbed. He wondered again whether or not the path of his son was 'filled stately to the brim' with stateliness. His voice was muffled. No serviette could wipe the tears in his heart. His scraped thoughts provided no relief. He knew not that fate could take such an inscrutable course that was so coarse. His face was representative of his perplexity. He wondered if his son was messing. Even after the presence of self-built consolation the thoughts smouldered. The quality of brevity rebuffed and spurned him. The thoughts were somewhat

penetrable. He wondered if the path was 'monstrous'. The pain was excruciating. The feelings 'thawed' as they grew in number. He was not sluggishly apprehending the course, it is something likely when one thinks one has been swindled by fate. One ponders over the pettiest of matters contemptuously. Damodardas walked in slush as he investigated the dilettante spirit of his son - all as he thought. He did not want to bristle or growl. He couldn't make a floaking jump. All the thoughts ripped his heart so full of fatherly love. He yelped with 'pain'. A wave of indecipherable thoughts swathed his mind and heart (if hearts could think). He couldn't understand the fatuity of thoughts well as they flew from the faucet of his mind. He just cauterised the wound in his heart with flames. He was so absorbed in contemplating, that he couldn't even reach a chiffonnier of the then present. His exasperation at finding something hollow was captivating. The resolute father paced athwart with a revolving concussion. Hobnails couldn't pierce his heart so much as the thoughts did. He was typically busy with his soliloquy. His heart crepitated as he pondered over the matter. There was a piebald as he thought. A number of skirmishes went on in his

own head which proved to be a beautiful battlefield. The penury of the thoughts went on. There was nothing ostentatious, it was all internal. It was quite unendurable for the dude. The thoughts were spasmodic. He could make neither head nor tail of his peripatetic son's future. He just considered that all that was to happen was inevitable. Such thoughts wrapped the mind of Damodardas. Later on he, trying to follow the ways of fate, left his worries and anxiety without any prorogation or procrastination. He put his trust in his son a bit.

Ad interim, Narendra arrived in Ahmedabad, the 'Manchester of India'. It is a metropolitan city today. Ahmedabad is vast and expansive. It's tedious to travel the entire city in a day. Today it is a centre of technology like Bengaluru. The cotton textile industry of Ahmedabad is, as a matter of fact, an agro-based industry. The cotton textile industry is one of the oldest industries of the modern world. Initially it flourished in Ahmedabad all because of the 'reliable' humid climate. However, today humidity can be created, irrespective of an obstacle, artificially. Another benefactory reason is that raw cotton is a pure

raw substance. It does not lose weight, that's why the industry has spread to other parts of India. Ahmedabad is one of the two most celebrated centres of the textile industry, the other one being Mumbai. Ahmedabad is situated on the banks of the river Sabarmati. The first cotton textile industry that was established in Ahmedabad flourished reasonably well. The geographical location of the city is really extremely advantageous. The raw material - cotton is provided by the cotton-growing areas of Gujarat. Hydroelectricity is largely available. It is a nice source of power for the machineries. Ahmedabad is quite close to the Arabian sea. Mariners and mercantile traders export textiles to the Middle East, Europe and Africa via the port of Kandla in Gujarat.

And, most essentially, the climate is just appropriate. It is humid - it makes it convenient for the production of textiles. Land, that is inhabited by factories, is available in Ahmedabad at relatively cheap rates. The water that is needed for the textile plants - for cleaning, amalgamating, washing, adding,

cooling machineries is, without much labour, available from the Sabarmati.

Ahmedabad's road and rail routes are well-connected with other important parts of Gujarat as well as those of the entire country. Lucre is especially needed for purchasing land and machineries. One can't employ labourers without lolly. No one is free enough to be a volunteer. Money is needed in every walk of life and industry is not an exception. Industries require money to finance their expenses. Money is earned by vending the produce. Ahmedabad is fortunate to have a big market. Gujarat, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh et cetera provide a ready market for the produced material. The dense population of the state also fulfils the requirement of cheap labour. These ingredients aid both the simple mills as well as the complex mills. There are various taxes imposed upon the material produced. This way it contributes a lot to the economic faculty of India. It is thus not only a major centre of cotton textiles but also a principal centre of economy. Ahmedabad is emerging as a technical textiles hub. Also, it is a culturally sanctified city.

Narendra placed his feet on the Manchester of India - a land where money makes the mare go - totally penniless. However, there was a variation this time. Formerly he wished to lead an ascetic life but, this time, he wished to work in the RSS. He did not have an intention to ascend in the spiritual field. His only ambition was to enter the stream of politics. Self-service and later on that of politics. Although impecunious financially he was rich in the field of ambition.

Politics is, qualmlessly, a dirty game. Corruption is the root of today's dirty politics. Likewise, political corruption is the root cause of all evil. The politics of today respects black-marketers, hoarders, profiteers and smugglers alone. Truthfully, the first and foremost cause of corruption in today's society is the dirty politics of politicians who have stuck the blood of the common men. Actually, when the leaders are corrupt how can one expect a clerk or a policeman to be honest? Politics has become a refuge for goondas and ruffians. There is hardly any institution that is not politicised. There is no department that is free from the clutches of dirty politics. Every government department is a

centre of illegal earning rather than that of public or animal welfare.

In the political field India is one of the most powerful nations of the world. Political parties must teach people that they are Indians first and then anything else. The politicians should be more disciplined. The politicians should sacrifice their personal interests in the interest of their country. A good political leader plays an important role in the social, political, economical and religious life of a nation. At present there is a dearth of good politicians like Mahatma Gandhi, Narendra Modi and Yogi Adityanath. People must rise up from their sleep and protest against all those responsible for dirty politics.

Most of our politicians have made India bankrupt. They hoarded money disgracefully. For them serving India is a way to serve their own interests. Today's leaders are like Bengolas who swallow the wealth of the poor. They are not what they show themselves to be. Contraband goods rest in their warehouses when the people are suffering. One may smile and smile and be a villain. The rich are

becoming richer and the poor poorer. However, all this criticism does not intend to uproot the 'politician system' of the country; rather eminent leaders like Narendra Modi are much needed for the betterment of the country. Politicians need to fend off India. Forsooth forthright people like Narendra Modi should definitely become politicians.

And, most notably, Narendra Modi feathered India's nest by entering the stream of politics.

India, in the 1970s, was not so easy-going as before. *The political turbulence of the decade had already announced itself in Gujarat before the Emergency descended upon India. In 1973, a student protest against rising food prices and corruption at an engineering college in Ahmedabad widened into the Nav Nirman Movement. What began within the walls of an educational institution soon passed into the streets, gathering students, members of the middle class and political opponents of the Congress government. The agitation spread across Gujarat and eventually compelled Chief Minister Chimanbhai Patel to resign. It became one of the earliest signs that public discontent*

could unsettle even a firmly established government.

The movement also altered the political atmosphere in which young organisers such as Narendra Modi worked. Gujarat had become a testing ground for opposition politics, civic mobilisation and resistance to administrative authority. When the Emergency was proclaimed in June 1975, the state therefore possessed both the memory of protest and a network of individuals already accustomed to organisation beneath conditions of political strain.

There was an uprising and even 'apt sustenance' of fervent vendetta in the family. People ran riot. The rip-roaring people ripped-off their near and dear ones. How sepulchre the atmosphere was! The riots started with the war against Pakistan. All this was followed by the unrest in the society. Paradoxically, the time of political dictatorship by the same party that had begotten us impunity began. As soon as the decade ended, the Congress again rose to power.

In 1970, Narendra's uncle Babubhai employed his nephew in a canteen. Narendra became a

steward. Meanwhile, Narendra contacted his preceptor, Vakil saheb. Narendra rendered help at the RSS headquarters, Hedgewar Bhawan. He did so to make himself useful. Vakil saheb came to know about the capabilities of the post-teenager then and there. He became familiar with his 'I can do it' attitude. The fact that Narendra couldn't and wouldn't flag off his principles like most of the flotsam was also brought into his notice. This nitty-gritty about the 'noddle noggin' made him see Narendra as nonpareil. After about a year and a half, Narendra was awarded the post of pracharak. Narendra had officially entered the RSS family. He had got a new sweet home.

The daily time-table of Narendra there is interesting to note. He would get up from bed at the early hour of 5 a.m. Then, he would fetch milk. After that he would wake everybody else up. Thereafter, the post-teenager would take part in the morning prayers. It would be followed by the preparation of tea which would be served to the members. The utensils would then be washed and cleaned. Then he would go to the RSS branch. After coming back he would prepare snacks for everyone. He would serve

breakfast. Thereafter he would sweep and mop the entire building. He would wash not only his own clothes but also the clothes of Vakil saheb. He would have his lunch at some swayamsevaks' domiciles seriatim. After coming back to the Bhawan he would prepare tea for everyone. Narendra was a true swayamsevak. Vakil saheb commanded Narendra to resume his education. He was sent off to study history. Narendra finished a course from Delhi University and obtained a degree in the subject of Political Science.

Narendra was a man who was absolutely engrossed in any work given to him. He would do it well and with unwavering concentration. He would constantly try to do better and better. Even the work he would initially not be interested in, would become tasteful for him as he would 'obsess' himself with the work. He would finish the work on time. Narendra was an influential disciplinarian. When he would work he wouldn't care about the past or the future. Only the present would matter. He loved the work he was given to do. Dedication and devotion - he would dedicate both of them to his work. Forsooth he would get so greatly

obsessed with the opus that he would become unmindful of the hard work that was to be done. He would only care about the quality of the work. Nothing on earth could undo this spirit of the man. He possessed a rejuvenating spirit. Slowly and steadily the workload became heavier than before.

It was ca or c three years after this Narendra had, dwelling in the Hedgewar Bhawan. He organized offices, transportation, the congregations etc. He became a prominent personality. You speak of a chore and he knew how to do that. He was an efficient administrator and an able manager as well. He would systematically organize and institutionalize meetings. He would look at the incoming mails and compile the answers. He started doing almost everything - from a chore to a job. This made him ascendingly important. Vakil saheb liked the management skills of Narendra. He appreciated the way Narendra would manage things and affairs.

The GLSS was summoned in the beginning of July. The chairman was Vakil saheb and Narendra was its General Secretary. This

evidently proved to be a vital turning point, the very transformative sculptor of Modi from Narendra. At the time of the appointment Narendra was hardly twenty-five years old but his administration and management skills were startling. It was really a big achievement.

Just after the enactment of the emergency Indira Gandhi came to know how much Gujarat could prick her - all because of the uprising RSS. The institution was debarred from functioning in the same way as it had been in 1948. The Congress, still not content, gave rise to a contention. It perceived the presence of ordnance and munition in the powwow places and the offices of the Sangh in Ahmedabad as 'illegal'. The official representatives were put behind bars. Narendra, being a junior worker was left sparingly without any spartan 'punishment'. Even then he was in a hazardous situation. He brought members to safety endangering or rather staking his own position.

The situation became worse and the police were after Narendra who employed his deft diplomacy. He wrote a list of contacts of people who could be entrusted with the completion of

the tasks invoking faith. He contacted aides to arrange domiciles for activists who sought places to hide when the police would seek them. That was a sort of 'hide-and-seek' game. He also started raising money for the expenses of the refugees. The outlay on the refugees was quite much. He arranged money for their disbursement. Narendra calculated that ten fearless families were required for fulfilling the requirements of every full-time underground worker. Many a Gujarati volunteered. This way many were rescued from being imprisoned.

There is an anecdote of Narendra's diplomatic skills. After Keshavrao Deshmukh's imprisonment, when he was in quod, it was found out that the precious papers for the future acts of the GLSS were with him and retrieving them was the need of the hour. Genius Narendra devised a way to get the papers back with the aid of a female swayamsevak from Maninagar he went to the police station where Deshmukh was inequitably kept. While the female swayamsevak presented herself as a relative, thumbs through the book-keeping Narendra got the documents after some ado. How keenly did he!

A tale recounts how Narendra met Vishnu Pandya, a journalist and Shankersinh Vaghela by breaking into the jail in Bhavnagar. He too has nicely disguised himself and employed a female activist to evade suspicion. This is another instance when Narendra employed his diplomatic skills.

Modi's part in the underground resistance was substantial, particularly in matters of communication, logistics and the protection of activists. Across India, journalists, students, trade unionists, socialists, Gandhians, members of the RSS and leaders of several opposition parties challenged the suspension of civil liberties. Modi's labour formed one thread in that wider fabric of resistance, and its significance is best understood not in isolation, but within the collective struggle that sustained democratic opposition during the Emergency.

The proletarian was the protagonist behind the peregrination to Gujarat of those antagonists of the Congress still at the stage of impunity. He ran into trade-union leader George Fernandes. George's brother had been imprisoned and tormented. Narendra would travel with

pamphlets and this was quite risky. To evade the risk he would often disguise himself. This way he could fulfil his purpose well without any chance of imminent and impending danger. He would, thus, be saved from peril. His ways of disguising were sober and simple. At times he would appear to be a seer in saffron costume with an emollient look. And the other times he would dress up as a turbaned Sikh with a simple chemise as the haut. The vêtement couldn't provide a hair-breadth guess of his originality. Even the expressions were endogenous. Once he was seated on a seat in the railway carriage. His appearance marked 'thumb up'! He had 'grown' thick hair and beard. His vieux école instituteur sat down à côté de his vieux étudiant. The disguise had so fully disguised Narendra that his instituteur couldn't recognise him. Later on the 'vieux instituteur' certified that his 'vieux étudiant' had introduced himself and also greeted his teacher.

The emergency did allow Narendra to attest to his spirit but it purged Narendra of want of political knowledge. It mattered to him. He was now no longer purblind, in the stream of politics. He got an opportunity to be with a

'party' of many other political parties. He was fortunate enough to work with the 'Gandhians', the Islamic organisations, the communist party and liberal organisations as well. This wedged the possibility of any further 'wants'. His knowledge and skills were enhanced as he experienced a lot. He consolidated his apprehension of the Indian Constitution and even other constitutions. He understood the unadulterated meaning of rights. This fostered the knurl of knowledge. The legacy, seemingly, now had a different course. Every laconic lacuna was filled. His knowledge became deeper as he worked with different organisations. He seemed to have undergone metamorphosis. The hobbledehoy hold on politics became tighter. Now that was not at all incoherent although formerly too it was uncomplicated for the master-mind man. He was now a political man who had become a dandified politician. The role of politics was no longer a mockery. His political mind had become as good as his vociferous speech. His skill was now at the apex. He became more wary. He gnawed the knowledge well. He knew how to resolve savage expostulations. All his endeavours became prolific. The deep

knowledge was now no longer decapitated. The shin of politics was now well-dressed.

After all he was a young 'bumpkin' (as his teachers used to call him) who had now burgeoned. Narendra, the same 'bumpkin' was now fluttering towards success deftly. He did not 'convulse' as before. He was now not an 'incontinent' child. He was no longer the object of the truncheon. He knew how to solve melees. He was exceedingly good at colloquies. He was not an amateur orator any longer. He was not a spasmodic thinker but a work of spacious and roomy tranquility. He was more copious-hearted than before and his visage was its display screen. He had a political protrusion and not a liquorish mind. He had eccentricity centered around embonpoint. That made him accentuated. His twine of mind was pricked with the art of political contemplation. He now went cadging knowledge not suspicion. That was not a promiscuous tramp but a race! Narendra was now a part of a race in which no lackadaisical or lacklustre man could take part. Narendra was now a brilliant interlocutor who had forgotten to play hopscotch but of course, he hadn't forgotten uttering hosanna. He

practised the art of ventriloquising - knowledge not the art of foolery, such was the aura around him. He was no longer desolate or shallow-minded. As before he was always the cynosure. Now, don't say I am anthropomorphizing him.

Narendra was often like flint but he wasn't flinty - not even a bit. He wasn't a flimsy dude, how could he be? He was born to be strong and to strengthen India. His knowledge ricocheted from its treasure trove. Politics couldn't snatch away his rectitude from him. It would only have to relinquish in that case. He could assimilate the rhetoric of party leaders. His rectitude couldn't, come what may, make him a renegade. He conducted the renaissance of 'good' politics if politics could ever be good. His acts confounded others and made them flabbergasted, they were so incredulous. Although he was a tramp he was not at all timorous. His rage was impotent. He was never in a tizzy, never. The scepticism that had exposed its head was soon to be decapitated quite impregnably. It is said that bizarre ideas transcending experience often have less effect upon men and women than smaller, more

tangible considerations but here the case was different.

Narendra was no longer tentative like a curate. The pungent of his 'promenading' towards success was about to make his opponents mottled.

On or c March 1977 when the delayed sixth Lok Sabha poll took place for the very first time in the history of independent India the Congress had lost the battle. The informal alliance presided over by the Janata Party won 345 seats whereas the Congress won only 189 seats. Morarji Desai became the Prime Minister and Atal Bihari Vajpayee became the Minister of External Affairs. *The victory of the Janata alliance in 1977 brought together political traditions that had previously stood apart. The Bharatiya Jana Sangh entered the Janata Party alongside socialists, Congress dissidents, agrarian leaders and other opponents of Indira Gandhi. For a brief moment, the common memory of the Emergency seemed sufficient to hold these diverse forces together.*

Yet the unity was fragile. Personal rivalries, ideological disagreements and disputes over the continuing association of former Jana Sangh leaders with the RSS gradually weakened the government. Morarji Desai resigned in July 1979, and the Janata experiment soon collapsed. Following the party's defeat in the 1980 general election, the former Jana Sangh members reorganised themselves. On 6 April 1980, the Bharatiya Janata Party was formally established, with Atal Bihari Vajpayee as its first president.

The hard work of Narendra, who had become prolific, had already prognosticated the victory. However, the alliance that did not constitute parties with similar national interests, collapsed in a short span of time - less than three years. As time flew by, many Indians who had taken birth after the enactment of the Emergency forgot about its occurrence.

De novo, in January 1980 Indira Gandhi was re-elected as the Prime Minister. But the noteworthy thing is that the RSS had emerged as a rising power. There were more chances of its success than before. The ante-and-après of

the emergency were absolutely different. That granted the organisation a kind of alacrity. It was no longer languid. The leaders had a transfer from the state of 'apprehension'. The state was not so limp as before. It was not poised delicately but grimly. The period of dictatorship allowed many Indians to discover that the RSS members were industrious and assiduous. The period of dictatorship had diverted the mind of many Indians. The period had presented before the Indians a second option — the Janata Party.

The RSS had solemn chances in both hands. From a somewhat 'alien' pioneer (at least to the Congress) the association had emerged as a 'like the rest of us'. The fantastic metamorphosis was much like the metamorphosis Narendra had undergone. It had become an 'adult'. RSS was no longer a 'child'. All this change was not age-wise, of course! But then the 'dictatorship' had already provided the Indians a worthy and somewhat 'better' alternative or option to opt for. The organisation had entered the mainstream. It was no longer 'at the periphery' or 'marginalised'. The 'dictatorship' also let people 'encounter' the RSS workers giving them

a chance to personally 'scrutinize' the activists who were so active! The emergency made the Congress fall in an 'exigency'. A priori - all was hopeful for the RSS.

The Emergency had led to a great alteration in the normal working of India. The havoc caused could not go answered. The royal party had a great legacy. Many Indians were emotionally attached to it, especially those who appreciated monarchy. They used to think that the Congress had the right to 'reign over' India as it had made the Indians independent from the tight clutches of British rule.

Some people liked the determination and assiduity with which the RSS workers worked. Previously they had never entertained such thoughts but now with the enactment of the emergency their thoughts altered their course.

That was a look aslant through a different window. The RSS could ascribe its 'being in the mainstream' to the Emergency. The RSS was spurting towards success. There was no need to figure out the cipher of its success fastidiously. It was now inside the container of huskiness. Its

success was no longer mere hallucination. It was no longer at the nape of success, it was deviant. The gesticulating leaders of the organisation were finally hopeful. Oblongly, the hopes could come true. Saying that was not 'pell-mell'. The leaders did not have to graze their hearts. RSS was there in the air if not in the breath.

And India needed a Raja not a second Raj.

The Heir of Advani

The period of the prime ministership of Morarji Desai was a period of incredible joy for the RSS not only because it had become a mainstream party but also because of the rise of the possibility of its surfacing as a government in future. So was the case with Narendra whose life was inflating. His activism during the emergency made him lucidly visible. Narendra, who worked actively during the time of the 'tremor' was now conducting the renaissance of the original functioning and modus operandi of the organisation. His coup and spotless work during the time of the havoc was not going to be fruitless. RSS had become renascent.

In 1978 he was posted as a sambhaag pracharak. A great trusty pracharak of the RSS, Narendra was now embarking on the path of success. Emendation had already taken place. His comrades trusted him. Lilliputian Modi was about to clamber upwards. He who had set to smitting the appalled opponents was not a young yokel but a gala youth. He was not to be

driven by the strongest consternation or fatigue. He was not in a spasmodic sort of hurry now. He was not to be slackened. He was eloquent, not floundering. He was neither in a state of funk nor was he ineffectual. He was the one who would make his opponents obsolete. Eris, the goddess of Discord and Altercation, who was quite desperate and lachrymose, paid great respect to the strong-minded man. The Gujarati pracharak was fated to soar to a much higher nest. How could he be enervated after all?

In 1979 Narendra was called to Delhi by Dattopant Thangadi, a senior RSS member. Narendra was proffered the task of researching and compiling the account of the emergency period. Narendra had befriended Thangadi during the 'underground meeting'. He had written a book in which he evaded the talk of his own industrious work. Narendra was riding the crest of a wave. Narendra who had previously been given a high post knew that taking up the job would enervate his status. But being broad-minded the debonair man set out to complete his job in toto. He, as usual, dedicated himself entirely to the documents that had to be prepared and the text that had to be rehearsed.

Passim the work he found out facts and pasty facts. He also threw light upon the causes and the results and the ligature betwixt the two. He steered and collated sporadically. The anomalous matter was arranged properly. Each and every rendezvous was mentioned by him. No, billions of facts were concealed. The purist and puritan kept his auricle alert. The bijou text was keenly and scrutinizingly scrutinized. Great punctiliousness was employed. The colloquies were recounted with expertise. He amassed great information and synthesized the material. He endowed it with deep details. Anything proximate to the details was mentioned. He coagulated axioms as well. The description was vivid and veiled. The facts were unbiased and could be relied upon. Keeping in mind the real facts the text was composed. The way of presentation was spontaneous and elating as it was well-embroidered. The text was annotated. Even the matter that was not much to-the-point was ejaculated. The modus operandi was pleasing and so he didn't have to scurry much.

The political organisation from which the Bharatiya Janata Party would eventually emerge

had existed since 1951, when Syama Prasad Mookerjee founded the Bharatiya Jana Sangh. Closely associated with the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh, the Jana Sangh sought to translate the RSS's cultural and nationalist ideas into electoral politics. Atal Bihari Vajpayee became one of its most prominent parliamentary leaders and, from 1968, served as its national president.

The Emergency imposed by Indira Gandhi between 1975 and 1977 brought several otherwise disparate opposition movements together. In 1977, the Jana Sangh dissolved itself and merged with the Bharatiya Lok Dal, the Congress (Organisation), the Socialist Party and other groups to form the Janata Party. The coalition defeated Congress in the general election, and Morarji Desai became India's first prime minister who did not belong to the Congress Party.

The unity of the Janata Party, however, proved fragile. Ideological differences, personal rivalries and disagreements over the continuing association of former Jana Sangh members with the RSS weakened the government. Morarji

Desai resigned in July 1979, and Charan Singh briefly succeeded him. When the Janata Party suffered a decisive defeat in the 1980 general election, its former Jana Sangh members reorganised themselves under a new name. On 6 April 1980, the Bharatiya Janata Party was formally established, with Atal Bihari Vajpayee as its first president.

One of the most consequential measures of the Desai government had been the establishment of the Second Backward Classes Commission in January 1979. Headed by B. P. Mandal, the commission was charged with identifying socially and educationally backward classes and recommending measures for improving their representation in public institutions. Its report, submitted in 1980, recommended a reservation of twenty-seven per cent in central government employment for the Other Backward Classes.

The commission did not itself create or immediately enforce these reservations. Its recommendations remained largely dormant for a decade and were taken up by the Union government only in 1990, when Prime Minister

V. P. Singh announced their implementation. The commission nevertheless placed caste, representation and access to state employment at the centre of Indian political debate.

The BJP inherited much of the Jana Sangh's organisation and cadre, but initially presented itself through the more moderate language of "Gandhian socialism" and democratic nationalism.

One of the most consequential initiatives of the Desai government was the establishment of the Second Backward Classes Commission in January 1979. Headed by B. P. Mandal, the commission was instructed to identify India's socially and educationally backward classes and recommend measures for improving their representation. Its report, submitted in 1980, estimated that the Other Backward Classes constituted a substantial portion of the Indian population and recommended reserving 27 per cent of positions in central government employment for them. The report was not immediately implemented, but it placed caste, representation and affirmative action at the centre of national political debate.

Meanwhile, Congress was rebuilding its political strength. In Gujarat, Madhavsinh Solanki developed a broad electoral coalition commonly known as KHAM—Kshatriyas, Harijans, Adivasis and Muslims. By bringing together communities that had historically possessed less political power, Congress sought to construct a durable majority beyond the traditionally influential Brahmin, Bania and Patidar communities. This was not merely an exercise in electoral arithmetic; it also reflected a wider struggle over which social groups would receive access to education, government employment and political representation.

Solanki became chief minister of Gujarat in June 1980 after Congress secured an overwhelming majority in the state assembly. His government's decision to expand reservations for socially and educationally backward groups generated intense opposition, particularly among sections of upper-caste students and professional communities. In 1981, protests against reservation began in educational institutions and soon spread through Ahmedabad and other parts of Gujarat. Demonstrations, strikes and attacks on public

property were followed by clashes with the police and episodes of caste and communal violence.

The newly formed BJP attempted to consolidate those who felt politically displaced by Congress's social coalition. The immediate electoral gains for the BJP were limited, but the conflict began to alter the social foundations of Gujarat's party system.

The intervening years were marked by national upheaval. In June 1984, the Indian Army entered the Golden Temple complex during Operation Blue Star. On 31 October of that year, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi was assassinated by two of her Sikh bodyguards. Her death was followed by organised anti-Sikh violence, especially in Delhi, and by a wave of grief and political sympathy that carried Rajiv Gandhi and the Congress to an overwhelming victory in the general election of December 1984.

The emotional force of that national moment also influenced politics in the states. Congress entered 1985 strengthened by sympathy, institutional power and the apparent promise of

generational renewal under Rajiv Gandhi. In Gujarat, this national tide combined with Solanki's social coalition to produce one of the greatest electoral victories in the state's history.

The tensions intensified again in 1985, when Solanki led Congress to a historic victory of 149 seats in the 182-member assembly. His government's attempt to increase reservations provoked another upper-caste agitation. What began as a dispute over caste-based quotas soon widened into prolonged urban disorder and communal violence, particularly in Ahmedabad. Solanki eventually resigned, but the unrest left enduring divisions within Gujarati society and accelerated the political realignment that would later benefit the BJP.

The unrest of 1985 was distinct from the riots of 1969 and from the agitation of 1981, even though the memory of earlier violence continued to haunt the city. Each arose from a different immediate cause, and each must be understood within its own historical moment. To merge them into one continuous conflict would obscure the changing character of Gujarat's political and social divisions.

These developments unfolded against a wider period of national turbulence. In June 1984, the Indian Army entered the Golden Temple complex in Amritsar during Operation Blue Star. On 31 October of that year, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi was assassinated by two of her Sikh bodyguards. Her killing was followed by organised anti-Sikh violence, particularly in Delhi, in which thousands were killed. Curfews, military deployments and communal anxieties became recurring features of Indian public life during the decade.

The violence in Ahmedabad's Dabgarwad neighbourhood, however, belonged to an earlier chapter. It occurred during the major communal riots of September 1969, more than a decade before the Mandal Commission and Solanki's reservation policies. In Dabgarwad, houses were set on fire and entire families were trapped inside them. The violence spread across Ahmedabad, leaving hundreds dead and tens of thousands displaced or deprived of their property. Official figures placed the overall death toll from the 1969 Gujarat riots at approximately 660, although other estimates were higher.

Ahmedabad had become a city in flames. Homes and shops were looted, neighbourhoods were divided along religious lines, and thousands of residents were forced to seek shelter elsewhere. The destruction in Dabgarwad came to symbolise the brutality of the riots, but it should not be presented as a consequence of OBC reservation or of the Mandal Commission. It arose from the communal violence of 1969 and must be understood within that distinct historical setting.

The later anti-reservation agitations of 1981 and 1985 had different immediate origins, although caste conflict and communal polarisation eventually became intertwined. It would therefore be too simplistic to describe the violence as either accidental or as the product of a single calculated conspiracy. Political parties undoubtedly sought to convert social divisions into electoral support, but the unrest also grew from long-standing inequalities, economic insecurity, competition for public opportunities and the weakening of institutions capable of mediating conflict. *Reservation, however, cannot alone bear the entire burden of explanation. The unrest emerged from the*

meeting of several forces: caste mobilisation, economic insecurity, competition for education and government employment, factional politics, urban frustration and the gradual intertwining of caste and communal identities. What began as resistance to a policy of affirmative action did not remain confined to that question. As the agitation widened, older resentments entered the conflict and transformed a dispute over public opportunity into a broader crisis of Gujarati society.

The events also began to reshape the state's political loyalties. Congress increasingly drew support from Dalits, Adivasis, Muslims and sections of the backward classes, while many Patidars, Brahmins, Banias and members of the urban middle class grew estranged from it. The BJP slowly entered this widening political space. Its rise was not immediate, nor was it produced by a single campaign; it emerged through municipal organisation, RSS networks, public dissatisfaction and the gradual reordering of Gujarat's social coalitions.

Congress's effort to assemble a coalition of historically marginalised communities

transformed Gujarat's electoral politics, but it also alienated sections of the socially dominant castes. The BJP gradually benefited from this alienation, while later attempting to construct a broader Hindu political identity that crossed some caste divisions. Thus, the upheavals surrounding reservation did more than destabilise one government: they helped reorder the political loyalties of Gujarat and created conditions in which the BJP could expand from a marginal organisation into a major political force.

During the early 1980s Narendra toured Gujarat. As an RSS regional organizer he first-hand witnessed the devastated landscape of the same state that was to be governed by him one day. In the 1980s the Adivasis and Other Backward classes got access to various benefits and schemes, and later on the beneficiaries were Muslims on a large scale, a nation-wide scale.

The system of the working of the RSS is quite democratic. It isn't torpid. The 'debate' is always held 'in curia'. Matters are discussed vividly and for hours. Narendra would always be seated on the last bench. He would listen to the

discussions intently. Narendra proved to be an eloquent orator and most vitally a patient listener. How dexterous he was!

In the 1980s a famine struck the state. Even fodder could not be made available for cattle. The RSS planned and finalized the plan. It did a lot of social service not only for the impecunious people but also for cattle. Money was substantially needed for the implementation of the project. Expenses proliferated.

It was decided that the RSS would ask for money at an international level. The matter was discussed for much time and when the finalization was to be done Narendra raised his clauses. He stated, "For the last four hours we have been discussing the matter. You did not utter a whim. Why do you barge into the matter this way? Why are you being so wanton and nauseating? Why are you so undulate? With no more time left, what are you going to say with so much gusto? Whatever it might be, it is grating. We have no time to 'vamp up a story' about the price of time. Our reverie calls it incoherent and appalling. That's a tout thing to

be done by louts. This much I can prognosticate. After the end of the continuum you want to foment wastage of time. There is no need to 'pussyfoot' around. Sitting like a pusillanimous being in the inception and the sloshing for a place can't ever raise and hoist the pennant. It will only cause perdition. No subvention can be begotten in this case. And bad news dawls fast. Isn't that worrisome?"

It surely was! Narendra, with his artistic ideas, was unequalled. How could anyone comprehend him?

Narendra replied, "If I am not wanted, I shall rear silence and I only have a suggestion to make." After mastication they consented and gave the approbation as they knew well that the suggestion won't be undulate or topsy-turvy. He wasn't a 'loony' for that.

Narendra who possessed prestidigitation began, "Why do we beg from foreigners, from people who are alien to us? Why is it so much required? We are a nation, a sovereign nation. We possess human power and intellectual prowess. The entire relief work ought to be

done on the substratum of our human prowess.
And the strategy would be distinct."

Narendra proffered the 'battle strategy'. He spoke, "We have innumerable relief workers. If only we could coagulate surplus one from each household or worker for half a year, it would be great. Railways will facilitate transportation. In lieu of storing water for cattle, cattle could be moved to green realms. Railways are being provided for service free of cost. That would also be a peremptory and imperious decision." So spoke the percipient who knew how to spatter the seeds of his thoughts well without any peregrination - only with his inscrutable speech.

They pondered over the matter for a while after which they decided to accept the suggestion which was not a mere 'whim'.

Gujarat has been, since time immemorial, a prestigious centre of culture and religion. I call it 'The Land of Bhakti'. Every temple has a breathtaking devotional song and every mosque is tranquil. Each one is a sweet place. Every kirk enjoys the green pastures. Every monastery

is the rendezvous for talks of non-violence. The markets are saturated with good goods. There are moneylenders and craftsmen. The vast gain temples are sacred and enlivening. Beauty might not be the ornament of the state but piety embroiders it well. One can't find a better place to live in than Gujarat but après the implementation of the reservation policy it lost its winsome glories. Leave alone the common man, even the police themselves started rioting. Every one was a 'high caste' or a 'low caste' person first and then a common man or a policeman. With broadened chests they stood on the battlefield all ready to fire and slosh and shoot the enemy dead as if they were thieves or ruffians. Journal bureaus were incinerated and the smouldered ashes were preserved. The citizens mowed down their co-citizens. The sustainers of law and order were now its greatest devastators.

Families and even the next-of-kin suffered from long years of desuetude, they were spurned. The battalion was visible permanently, not transiently. Industries and factories could not remain unaffected in the hustle and bustle. They were shut down.

Narendra went on with his work. The Bharatiya Janata Party had recently won the 'territories' of Junagadh and Rajkot in the municipal elections the previous May.

Indira Gandhi's assassination made Indians emotional. Many Indians became sympathetic towards the Congress. In the 1984 general election Rajiv Gandhi, the offspring of Indira Gandhi, formed the government with a startling majority — the largest in the history of free India. The Congress won 414 seats in the Lok Sabha while the BJP gained access to two alone. It was a rip in its shape.

Sadly enough Indira Gandhi could not remain alive to witness the stupendous victory but ironically her demise was the victory's cause.

Rajiv Gandhi hastily crowned Amarsingh Chowdhary as the chief Minister after disposing and deprecating the perilous chief Minister Madhav Singh Solanki. That month itself Vakil Saheb passed away. It was a bolt from the blue for Narendra. As Amarsinh Chowdhary began his work peace arose in the state. It seemed as if

Madhav Singh Solanki had personally provoked many.

From 1986 to 1988 there were approximately 100 bomb explosions. It was the vestige of a communal disaster.

Gujarat divided itself. Common communities settled together and formed ghettos. Barriers were created. They restricted 'invaders' not 'guests'. Humorously the fence betwixt Hindu and Muslim realms were given the epithet 'stockade'. Demarcation came into being. 'Pakistan' was the name given to the 'Indian' Muslim neighbourhoods. We didn't have to go in pursuit of Pakistan to Pakistan, we had it in India itself. Likewise the Congress was internally demarcated. Amarsingh Chowdhary and several comrades of the 'extant' (as he thought himself to be) chief Minister Madhav Singh Solanki considered themselves to be two different entities in the same manner as 'artificial' philosophers consider god and soul to be different.

The misdeeds of Madhav Singh Solanki were extenuated and exterminated and extirpated on paper. People connived at his culpable deeds.

As the Ahmedabad municipal elections approached in February 1987 Narendra was commissioned to administer the campaign. The modus operandi of Narendra culminated in the triumph of the Bharatiya Janata Party which secured two-thirds of the seats in the municipality without any gerrymandering. The tables had turned! The Congress got swathed with anxiety and trepidation. It was not a trifling matter. The party knew that it would have to bear the blow of all the skirmishes carved.

In 1986 Lal Krishna Advani became the party president. Narendra had established comradeship with Advani at the time of the emergency. In 1987 Narendra became the organizing secretary of Gujarat of the BJP when he was proffered the post by Advani.

Ad interim, Rajiv Gandhi was fancying the modernization of the country.

The Shah Bano case portrays his approach. Shah Bano was a Muslim femme who hailed from Indore in Madhya Pradesh. Her condition was quite pitiable. She had been abandoned and left desolate by her attorney. The legal practitioner did not consent and objected to paying the money allowance paid by a man to his ex consort après legal segregation i.e. alimony, as he was bound to do under Criminal Procedure Code Section 125.

The solicitor filed a suit that alleged against the Indian state for interrupting and intervening in the personal lives of Muslims. The case travelled to the Supreme Court and was disposed of. Shah Bano being an Indian woman had the right to alimony. The Islamic followers raised their voice against the 'injustice' being done to 'them' and their culture. They made Rajiv Gandhi recollect his memory and reminded him of the votes Muslims had bestowed upon the party. Fauleen Singh, a journalist, alone highlighted Shah Bano at that time. The way of presentation invoked great pity. Many people commiserated.

Nevertheless Rajiv Gandhi decided to pass a law, the Muslim Women (Protection of Rights on Divorce) Act, 1986. It seemed as if he had 'counteracted' the judgement of the Supreme Court, that possessed so much acumen. This denied Muslim women their rights as Indian citizens. That was a 'reversal' of the definition of secularism according to which we are Indians first and then anything else, so all religions ought to be treated equally.

The depravity, however, benefitted the BJP which was now not very dubious of its success. Indubitable was its success. The act discriminated and stereotyped between Muslims and non-Muslims as the non-Muslim men were still not free from the liability for maintenance which couldn't even be ropery. That was an alteration in the definition of secularism again.

The inexpert misjudgement would cost him a lot in the 1989 Lok Sabha election. That was not the last wanton step. The Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi despite being undulate tried to be even. He commanded the doors of the Babri Masjid in Ayodhya to be unlocked for Hindus

as well — not for the 'wearers of fez' alone. The Babri Masjid problem was quite inextricable.

The Babri Masjid was established by Babur in 1527. The first Mughal emperor of India and the historical beginner of the Mughal Dynasty had built the mosque, apparently, named after him. It is currently at Ayodhya in Uttar Pradesh.

Ayodhya is a religious place for the Hindus as it is one of the seven sacred places of pilgrimage in India. It was colonised and founded by Manu, the first king and the author of the Manu Smriti. Lord Ramchandra, the delighter of the solar dynasty, was born here. It was he and many of his ancestors who ruled from the capital city. Sanctified by Sarayu, a sacred river, Ayodhya is one of the principal sacred cities of the Hindus. Until the mid 1800s both the Hindus and Muslims proffered worship to their respective deities there. After the premier war of Indian independence in 1857 Hindus, on account of some skirmishes, were compelled to stop their worship. One of the domes of the Masjid was destructed in 1934 during the intense rioting. The British cured the damage. After the partition the idols of Ramchandrajī

and his associates were set up in the mosque itself. The Hindu vote was required by the Congress in the then upcoming elections in Ayodhya. But the inexorable Hindus were quite unyielding. The idols remained intact. After the elections the building remained locked throughout the year excluding a day when a Brahmin priest was 'permitted' to worship the deities by observing the due rites and rituals.

And now the Hindus gained easy access to the shrine once again. Ayodhya was no longer a calm place. The orthodox Vishwa Hindu Parishad demanded that the mosque be replaced with a sacred Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Ram. The Ram Janmabhoomi campaign, which literally means 'The Campaign for the Land of Birth of Ram', began in 1984. The campaign spread and spattered like wildfire as the propagator of Hindu religion.

Narendra, with his never-ending appealing ideas and indomitable gumption soon became popular with people. That was a pigment of his flourishing success. Even the scant words of Narendra never possessed inanity. The iridescent tapetum glowed with every

attainment. The chance of attainment was not 'inarticulate' now. Narendra devised and shaped his idea in the form of the Nyaya yatra. The literal meaning of the words 'Nyaya' is 'justice' and 'yatra' means 'journey'. Hence, Nyaya yatra means the journey for the attainment of justice. A rath yatra, at least in political terms, is not only related to religion or its propagation but also to politics. As the yatra would go on the countryside people come in contact with the subtleties of politics centred in urban areas. This way the chariot festival acts as a medium for spreading optimal fame. The rath yatra associated with Lord Jagannath is greatly auspicious. Formerly, the monarchs themselves would sweep the floors of the chariots which carried the deities (in wooden form) to achieve their blessings. To witness the deities and earn their blessings devotees would flood the area. This was an effective way to reach the people dwelling in remote areas which were not easily in reach. This people, living in wop-wops, too had the right to vote. Their emotional and religious attachment would be converted into political attachment in the same way as solar energy is converted into light energy. Besides, these decorated trucks and tractors 'containing'

lucky goods i.e. politicians also accompanied the chariots containing the idols. Speeches would be spoken and heard, promises and complaints made and reasoned. In the countryside the party gained a lot of gain as the remote villages would become accessible. Narendra desired the yatra to proceed through many, many hamlets all over the state. He wanted each and every nook and corner to be covered.

In 1987 the programme of 'Integral Humanism', the master-creation of Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyaya was adopted by the party. He wanted to inverse the common descending order of governance and wanted it to be ascending. He wanted the subjects to be the centre and who would form the integrated democratic governance. That was his far-sighted vision. Upadhyaya's famous call 'Modernization not Westernization' depicted his philosophy regarding modernization. Today Indians find modernization to be synonymous with westernization. The call pressurized the difference more than anything else. He believed that the imitation of western manners or culture was not success but stepping on puddles. He

liked the modernization that suited the requirements of Indians in lieu of direct imitation. In simple terms, *exempli gratia*, accepting modern way of costuming and accepting the modern way of synthesising the fabrics (using synthetic materials and machines) are two different things with the first one being an example of westernization and the second one being that of modernization. Upadhyaya believed that Indians are Indians first. The other coordinate points were secondary. Consequently everyone should be served as an Indian not as a Hindu or a Muslim etc. He wanted every Indian to take deeper pride in being an Indian than in being a Hindu or a Muslim or anyone else. The principle of Antyodaya was also his creation.

In 1989 Narendra planned the Lok Shakti Rath Yatra. 'Lok Shakti' intends to convey 'The People's Prowess'. The journey began from 31 January onwards. Narendra was, *plus ou moins*, the noddle of the yatra. The origin was the temple of Bhakti at Ambaji. It went through 10000 hamlets. It was the first yatra that successfully impressed the tribal people of eastern Gujarat. The year witnessed another

incident connected to Narendra. His father Damodardas yielded to the ghost. His soul ascended to heaven leaving the earth when his son was busy with political earthly matters. He would never return in that form. For the last many years Narendra had not been in touch with him but now he went back to his hometown. The visit, as expected to be made by such a man, was concise and abridged.

Narendra formulated a plan for the next yatra. On 25 September 1990 the megastar Somnath-Ayodhya yatra commenced from the Somnath Temple in western Gujarat which houses one of the twelve Jyotirlinga shrines. The temple dedicated to Lord Som or Moon and Lord Chandrashekhar was rebuilt by the Iron Man of India Sardar Patel in 1950. The yatra had to pause at the Babri Masjid in Ayodhya. Nevertheless it made great strides.

In New Delhi the largest Muslim rally apres the impunity of India was organised in March 1987. 3,00,000 protestants coagulated, strode, claimed and demanded that the mosque be locked for Hindus for good.

The most noticeable thing worthy of notice was that the Masjid had many likes. The Jama Masjid does hold great significance but the primary and premier reason for the elevation of the public status of the Babri Masjid was the Vishwa Hindu Parishad. After all, how could the Muslims step back when claims were being made to replace the mosque with a Hindu temple? They too loved their religion especially when comparison was being made. And, the truth is that the defenders of a particular religion are its followers alone. It is the truth we have it as today. In the age of Kaliyuga it changes with the passage of time but it is true, you know and we have to accept it.

Muslims also did what was needful just as the Hindus. Both were protecting their own religions with a separatist view when it should have been nationalistic.

However, sometimes conditions matter more than truth as truth itself changes in accordance with conditions.

And the truth had to change not for the sake of truth but for the sake of people — for solving the skirmish.

The conditions were different for the Hindus. Ayodhya was of great religious consequence to the Hindus. If only Muslims had sacrificed a mosque for the whole city the melee would have stopped. But how could and why would the Muslims sacrifice 'their' mosque when the world would remember the triumph of Hindus not as a victory over a mosque but as a splendid victory? What cowardice would allow Muslims to be named 'Forsakers of Islam' when the foreigners who were the supporters of Islam would bend their heads low and Hindus would broaden their chests? And surely, why would they lose their identity as Muslims when Hindus couldn't lose their own identity? So, why should they be called betrayers of their own religion — their identity, when the Hindus would be enjoying themselves? And then, why would any human lose his identity which is the answer to the biggest question — 'Who are you?' which cost a reputed leader his life?

The wars could have ended if no one had intervened, but then why would Hindus sit like dumb fellows when their age-old or rather ages-old sacred place was being snatched away from them, that too when, historically, it was older than the mosque?

As always, it had to happen, so it happened. Even the then conditions stated this. Ayodhya is the birthplace of Lord Ram, the incarnation of Lord Vishnu. It was the place of birth of the Lord and could not be substituted.

As the yatra entered Bihar Lalu Prasad Yadav of the Rashtriya Janata Dal stopped it from stepping further. Lalu Prasad Yadav couldn't forget the votes Muslim had brought for him and so couldn't allow the Hindu yatra in. Advani was arrested at Dumka. He was then kept in confinement at a dargah-house of the irrigation department of the state on the banks of the Mayurakshi fleuve à côté de Massanjore Dam. On 30 October the yatra ultimately halted at Ayodhya. The youths of the Sangh aggressively and viciously raised torrents of arrows and established the Hindu Standard. The ensign-plantation was sure to end in devilry.

How could it go unanswered in a religiously diverse country? Consequently the inky and abject violence began. The burly men became homicidal. That was not incredulous but the truth, the truth of the hour. People were smashed like buildings. No one was knavish here. Everyone was honest to one's own faith. The snivelling people attacked and vanished. That was the war of and for faith and rightly like the Mahabharat War it was the war of righteousness. Here either the Hindus would win over the Muslims or vice versa unlike the Mahabharat war that ended in the victory of good over evil. If only a particular religion could substitute 'good' the case would be solved. But here the case was quite different. Everyone was fighting to prove his own religion good, and so how could they substitute any one of the religions with 'good' so easily? They wouldn't surrender. The consequence of the circumstance was that fifty people were shot dead by the bullets emanating from the guns of the police. A volcanic eruption took place. In that eruption rioting was the volcano and the deaths of 200 people in Gujarat the consequence. The magma was religion.

In the 1990 state elections the Janata Dal took over.

Narendra, too, became a fruit-bearing tree. In 1990 he became one of the 17 members of BJP's National election Committee. That was the accolade of Narendra's organizational work in the RSS. It was for the first time after 1987 when he joined the BJP that Narendra had a chance to work outside the BJP.

He planned the ekta yatra expected to last for 47 days after the Somnath-Ayodhya yatra. He remained, for the very first time, on board for as much time as the span of the yatra. The yatra began from Kanyakumari in the southernmost state of the country, Tamil Nadu in December 1991 with BJP national president Murli Manohar Joshi. The yatra halted at Srinagar in Kashmir at the time of le four de l'An. The separatists challenged the ensign-raisers of the yatra to a duel. And then Narendra spurned the advice he had been given. He was advised to wear the armour but he refused to do so. It depicted not only his valour but also the dire need to incinerate terrorism's very root.

When Narendra came back to Gujarat after having successfully completed the yatra he was deprecated by Shankersinh Vaghela who had recently been elected as a Member of Parliament. It was not a faint humiliation. It was a big error committed by the serrated Vaghela who had removed a trusty man from his post and to top it all the man was not a mere trustworthy fellow but one who worked ad-infinitum. The act evinced the fact that a spook had entered hapless Vaghela's mind. The way he stigmatised Narendra would only ruin him the same way indirectly. One of the possible reasons for the stifle could also be the aid Narendra had rendered to Vaghela's sworn foe, Keshubhai Patel in the Lok Shakti Rath Yatra. Another cause could be the cropped-up envy caused by the presence of a junior doing better.

Anyway, Shankersinh Vaghela was the cause of all causes. Forsooth an envious friend is far worse than an envious enemy. Patient Narendra 'walked away'. He established Sanskardham, a secondary school in Ahmedabad. The title 'Abode of Sanskars' corresponded to the teaching well. It was a tribute to his late mentor, Vakil Saheb. The school started functioning

from 6 June onwards in the year 1992. He employed all his management and administration skills for the 'well-being' of the school. He wouldn't discard the slightest of subjects. He instructed the way to 'worship' guests, organize exhibitions and see that the drivers of the visitors were well taken care of. He commanded the way of teaching and the way of learning. Narendra considered the school to be his own family and regarded the students as the members of the family. As Narendra managed the school and handled its affairs Lal Krishna Advani remained involved in the preparation for the demolition of the Babri Masjid in December 1992. But it had nothing to do with the forty-two-year old.

Let's pry into the Ayodhya episode while Narendra was devoting his heart and soul to Sanskardham École. Advani and many other eminent leaders went to Ayodhya on 5 December 1992. The customary stone-laying ritual the next day would portray the construction of the Ram Mandir. On 6 December the Masjid was crumpled. Communal riots followed in succession. The struggle was sudorific. 2000 priceless lives became

price'less', as they ended but the price of grief soared to its highest height. Most of the life-losers but not faith-losers were Muslims. Streams of blood flowed through Delhi, Mumbai and Gujarat. The water in the streams was sufficient to quench the thirst of the martyrs for whom martyrdom was the only religion that existed. Ahmedabad and Surat saw blood raining. Aggressive Hindus had several reasons for being aggressive. The reasons became the principal cause of the rain of blood. The destruction of the Babri Masjid was a thorn in the lotus feet of Indian secularism. The devastation took place, lives shattered, buildings collapsed, blood rained and other such savage things happened. The lives that ceased to exist did not have to bear any humiliation. The world would remember them with respect. The worst affected man was P.M. P.V. Narasimha Rao who had to be 'answerable'. Miscellaneous questions were raised. The Prime Minister was criticised. Poetic devices like the simile, metaphor, hyperbole, anaphora and epistrophe (symploce) were freely utilised. Some said that he only slept all the time. Others said that he had a huge appetite. The criticism did not know any end. The adjectives used were tumid. The

statements were perspicuous and lucid. The psalms of his weakness were sung. All this could, however, not lessen the death toll or the grief.

The flames of rioting enveloped Gujarat. There was harum-scarum killing going on everywhere. The flame paced athwart. Crepitation was often heard. There were spasmodic gusts of violence. Frantic gesticulations were used to help friends and 'swords' used to kill enemies. All the bloodshed was too belated to revive the dead. They were only too elated to take revenge. People bashed one another. Audible imprecation came from within as people were devoured. Everything happened lumpily. The brilliant bodies lay covered with mud and blood emanating a glimmer of red light shining through a graze in the flesh. Body ingredients splashed in a puddle of blood. Enemies were looked at with venomous tongues. The burglary of burnt ashes — the remnants of the incineration — was common. The distinct act of fumbling the ajar dead was usual and some even avoided a touch.

Pokers descended as bodies fell and stumbled and tumbled. Conflicts arose due to sectionalism and sectional interests. People shouted and raised slogans giving rise to a babel. Survivors had an impulse to place the ashes in a scuttle. Sectarianism raised its ugly head. Sarsaparilla was taken for obtaining 'energy' for the strenuous work. Their alacrity knew no bounds. The bodies lay strewn. The jaunty hands ascertained the struggle done for killing 'religious foes'. The only restoratives for wounded fellows were the ashes of the dead. The faith in one's own faith was tremendous. The skirmish became fiercer with every passing minute.

The skirmishes in BJP itself were fiercer. Three people cropped up in BJP (in Gujarat) as the early 1995 state elections approached. The nomenclature marked Keshubhai Patel, Shankersinh Vaghela and sedulous Narendra Modi. In 1992 Narendra had been exiled. Vaghela was an ambitious man who knew the real meaning of 'power'. He respected his interests more than the interests of the party. Narendra was his sworn enemy as he was the supporter of Keshubhai.

Lal Krishna Advani returned to the presidency of the Bharatiya Janata Party in 1993. By then, Narendra Modi had already accumulated considerable organisational experience. The RSS had assigned him to work with the BJP in the mid-1980s, and in 1987 he became an organising secretary of the party's Gujarat unit. That same year, he played an important role in the BJP's successful campaign for the Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation, a victory that demonstrated the party's growing strength in Gujarat.

Modi subsequently became involved in campaigns of national significance. He assisted in organising Advani's Ram Rath Yatra in 1990 and Murli Manohar Joshi's Ekta Yatra of 1991–92. These assignments strengthened his reputation as a disciplined organiser capable of coordinating workers, routes, meetings and communications across large territories. After briefly withdrawing from frontline politics amid disagreements within the Gujarat organisation, he returned to active electoral work in 1994, partly at Advani's urging.

On returning, Modi was entrusted with strengthening the BJP's organisation throughout Gujarat. He helped supervise and train a vast network of party workers, improved communication between the state leadership and local units, and encouraged systematic preparation at the constituency and polling-booth levels. His method was based less on personal spectacle than on persistent organisational work: studying local conditions, identifying weaknesses, assigning responsibilities and ensuring that instructions were carried through.

By this time, the political ground in Gujarat had begun to shift decisively. Congress, which had once dominated the state through its KHAM coalition, was weakened by internal divisions, administrative discontent and the erosion of support among several influential communities. The BJP, meanwhile, had expanded beyond its traditional urban and upper-caste base. Its successes in municipal and local elections gave the party confidence that it could form a government on its own.

Modi's contribution formed one part of a wider collective effort involving party leaders, RSS workers, local candidates and thousands of volunteers. He helped bring discipline and coherence to the campaign, but the BJP's advance also depended upon public dissatisfaction with Congress and the leadership of senior Gujarat figures such as Keshubhai Patel and Shankersinh Vaghela. The two men represented powerful currents within the state party, although rivalry between their supporters would later produce a serious internal crisis.

During the 1995 campaign, Modi reportedly maintained close contact with candidates and local organisers across all 182 constituencies. The party presented itself as an alternative to Congress misrule and promised a government free from fear, hunger and corruption. Its organisational machinery reached from the state headquarters to individual polling booths, allowing campaign messages, voter information and local grievances to move rapidly through the party network.

The electoral result was historic. The BJP won 121 of the 182 seats in the Gujarat Legislative

Assembly, securing its first independent majority in the state. Congress was reduced to 45 seats. Keshubhai Patel was sworn in as chief minister on 14 March 1995.

The victory, however, concealed an approaching struggle within the party. Shankersinh Vaghela had commanded considerable support among BJP legislators and believed that his own role in building the party entitled him to greater influence. Keshubhai Patel's selection as chief minister therefore left him deeply dissatisfied. What appeared to be the beginning of a stable BJP government soon gave way to factional rivalry, rebellion and a contest for control of the party in Gujarat.

When Keshubhai Patel was in the United States out of some work Vaghela and his forty-seven MLA aides hit the road and flew to Khajuraho in Madhya Pradesh and sussed out.

How could the trio hit it off?

They were hitting on when Vaghela stated that he had won the support of the Congress. Vaghela could win by achieving a majority with the additional succour of forty-five MLAs of the Congress. His idea was succinct.

The rendezvous was a hotel that was plus ou moins a rotunda. Vaghela, who wasn't even able to breathe because of political asphyxia, had selected it. He was just moping around. He was moving from pillar to post.

Vaghela's shrewd and perceptive plan succeeded and Keshubhai was appointed as the national vice-president of the BJP. The Chief-Ministership was handed over to Suresh Mehta. In accordance with the compromise made previously Narendra was exiled. As he prepared his resignation Advani intervened.

On 20 November in 1995 Narendra was appointed a national secretary of the Bharatiya Janata Party. (His elevation to the office of national general secretary came later, in 1998.)

Narendra settled in the metropolis of India. In 1996 Narendra was commanded to administer

the BJP in Himachal Pradesh, Haryana, Chandigarh, Punjab as well as Jammu and Kashmir. Narendra was a charismatic person. Narendra's organizational work led to success in those areas. Narendra's 'jaunts' in the north inflated his knowledge. He got a chance to work with outsiders and widen his horizon of knowledge.

The atmosphere of Gujarat became worse than before. In the month of September in 1996 President's Rule was imposed on Gujarat. Suresh Mehta had tried to achieve votes in a knavish way. He had been the cause of his own affront. Shankersinh Vaghela revolted. His demand was more of an imposition. The adamant man set out for founding the Rashtriya Janata Party with his tread pronto. He left the BJP in August 1997. He was indeed a perfidious renegade. He sloshed the BJP as he left after the retirement of President's Rule adamant Vaghela's long-cherished dream came true.

On 8 February 1997 the triumph in Gujarat by-election in the Sarkhej ward brought Amit Shah into the state assembly. Shri Atal Bihari

Vajpayee immortalised his name in the history of the Bharatiya Janata Party by becoming the first P.M. of India from the party. The span was short — only thirteen days; and the historic day for the BJP was one of the 31 days of May and the year was 1996. But Atal Bihari Vajpayee had to rise to the feet because of the lack of a parliamentary majority.

Ad interim Vaghela sat on the ceremonial seat as the Chief Minister of Gujarat. He could achieve the seat only after making serious allegations against the BJP in the name of corruption. His accomplice from the RJP, Dilipbhai Ramanbhai Parikh succeeded him but only for a short duration. He got the opportunity when Vaghela had been dismissed as a corrupt leader. Vaghela became effete. The governance was quite anhydrous. Assembly elections were held anew on 4 March 1998. In the elections Vaghela got a handful of seats — just four in number — not even a 'handful' actually. He joined the node of the stem of the Congress like a branch that would support corruption. This led to the addition of his votes to those of the Congress. RJP's four seats were added to the fifty-three seats of the Congress. Nevertheless

BJP remained unconquerable. It could not be overpowered. It won 117 of the total 182 seats in the assembly. Keshubhai Patel became the Chief Minister of Gujarat.

On 19 May 1998 Narendra became the BJP's National General Secretary. He became the BJP spokesman in 1999 as a result of his long-lasting impression on Atal Bihari Vajpayee. He traveled to over forty countries including Malaysia and Australia. Narendra, who had toured each and every nook of the country, could now boast of being a traveler who had scrutinized the foreign lands. As he represented the country he became the object of journalists. He was proficient in answering unanswerable questions after they had debilitated him. This closed the 'nit-wit theory' altogether. He was there in Kashmir when the Kargil war broke out. He was, thus, a trustworthy resource for the questionnaire of the media.

Under the misgovernance of Keshubhai corruption bred everywhere. The BJP was deeply wounded in the Ahmedabad and Rajkot municipal elections of the year 2000. The vote share of the party fell from 80 per cent to 20

percent. The Sabarmati assembly seat was lost by the party as easily as one loses a seat in the cinema hall. The party suffered the same fate in the case of the Sabarkantha Lok Sabha seat. It was a huge misfortune.

The disastrous Kutch earthquake rose on 26 January 2001 to make matters worse. The powerful earthquake measuring 7 on the Richter scale struck the state. It gave rise to enormous damage killing more than 20000 people and destructing approximately four lakh domains. About sixteen million people were either directly or indirectly affected by the devastating earthquake. The earthquake's epicenter was in close proximity to Bhuj in Kachchh. The region around Bhuj, therefore, endured the most damage. Thumbing through the records of the previous earthquakes the danger and risk of vehement and errant earthquakes is culminating in the Bhuj region. Also, it is fairly densely populated. These were the significant reasons for the 'heavy' death toll. Relief operations were supposed to be terse. The administration was considered to be inefficient.

Narendra was the lover of Indians and Indians were his lovers. A beautiful incident beautifully portrays it. On 28 June in the year 2000 Narendra visited Gujarat. His visit was not anticipated. The occasion saw the reunion of those who had been held in custody during the emergency — a quarter of a century ago.

Narendra's chair was placed near the stage chamber. The BJP National President called Narendra forward and honoured him ritualistically with a foulard and va lei. As he was being honoured customarily the crowd cheered. There was chaos everywhere. The environment became obstreperous. This depicted that Narendra was the beloved of the public. The dignitaries were startled and each one could only exclaim, "My stars and my stockings!" Narendra had many aficionados.

Afterwards on 1st October 2001 Vajpayee and Narendra congregated. Vajpayee, indirectly stated through a pricey statement (a chestnut) stated that he wanted him to go back to Gujarat. He said that Narendra had become corpulent and was not so attenuated as before. He presented the excuse himself saying that it was

all because of scoffing at the 'Delhi repast' which was not salubrious. He thought whether the statement was incoherent for the 'Gujarat lad' or not and so he presented it vividly. He suggested Narendra go back to Gujarat and work there itself. It was indeed a non sequitur for any foreigner. When Narendra asked if that meant he would lose track of the other state he was told that he would be supplanting Keshubhai. Narendra straightforwardly replied in the negative. He also learnt the rhetoric of the party leaders. Vajpayee kept insisting and Narendra persistently refused. Vajpayee told him that he was boisterous and influential but the only answer was "NO!"

Later Advani told him that everyone found him to be a suitable candidate. On 4 October Narendra was elected as the new captain of the BJP legislative party. On 7 October 2001 Narendra pledged and became the Chief Minister of the 'Land of Piety'.

Narendra did not forget visiting his old deary, mother not as a part of a perfunctory act but as a way to invoke her blessings. She advised her 'baby' not to take any nibble.

That was a tinge of emotion. He was the same bébé for his Maa, the very same child who wriggled delightfully. This is the work of destiny. The wriggling baby (walking towards his mother) was now a wriggling Chief Minister (walking towards success). The sagacious mother's sagacious son was now a sagacious Chief Minister who had been scoured by his sagacity and who possessed noticeable manoeuvre.

Indeed, we can't say what our future expectations are because the future is something we can't look into. We just have to wait and see how destiny unfolds.

The Divine Potency

An apple of Atalji's eyes

It was the dawn of the twenty-seventh day of February, the second in the race of the twelve months of the year 2002. The rising sun rose. It knew that it had to set as well. So, it hurried to make up for the loss. The haste of the sun was nowhere like the haste of the two thousand and three hundred passengers being carried by the Sabarmati express late by five hours. Now, five hours is not a short space of time, at least not for the sun. But in India it is OK. We often relate punctuality to coming on time or 'going by the watch'. If someone arrives behind the time he is late. And if one arrives ante the time, then one is early but not 'behind hand'. Why? The answer is as simple as the question — being the 'early bird' is a good habit. We tardily know that this 'bird' too is not punctual, but come on, it's India.

India is a truly beautiful place. The tall neem and gulmohar trees surround this pretty land and the expansive waters of the rivers propound and expound its beauty. The mountains cradle

this land. This is the land of the Indians, the jesters of India. India is unique in its own way. It is the land of poets, astrologers, pandits, clown-like figures, stupendous jardins and eggheads. The culture of India enlivens the soul. The war-horses of India are braver than the bravest. They don't know what fear is. Even the war brides are as brave as their valiant consorts. When people are given good wiggling by their elders they never feel humiliated. Here elders, even dead elders are worshipped. But at the same time Indians possess a great possession of self-respect. By dint of this touching sentiment alone India is a self-respecting and self-sufficient land where there is no diminution in any sort of virtue. Even the dilatory have dilated minds.

The people of India consider India to be their mother. India is revered by her children, so she loves them. The reason why she is called 'Mother' is that she possesses two breasts in the form of the Ganga and the Yamuna. The relation between the Indians and India is touching and sentimental. Indians are flexible in the sense that they have a ready and inborn quality of tolerance. Spats do occur in India but

they occur only when a particular sect's self-respect is affected. 'A spate of welcoming words' — that's what India is famous for. Thralldom doesn't exist in India. India is indeed disparate. This is where deer and lions drink water from the same stream. It can hardly be delineated. Humans and animals live peacefully together. India alone has the power to spread and propagate peace all over the world. India is 'Vishwaguru'. And Narendra had taken birth to make the world accept the fact.

The Sabarmati express or rather the 'Nocturnal Train' arrived at 7:42 a.m. (non-nocturnal timing). The station was in the Panchmahal district. The train had Ramsevak's placed on its lap. These aides of Ram were coming back from the birthplace of Lord Ram in Uttar Pradesh. They were coming back after a long journey. Anyone who has visited Ayodhya and the people's hometown can calculate the distance between the two. The train stopped at Godhra junction to take a siesta. As it melted away people (passengers) were attacked with stones. It wasn't about to finish so soon. After running for about 7 km the train stopped — this time not for siesta. The train couldn't rest with

all the bulging unrest. The reason was drifting — someone had pulled the emergency chain. With its extension vacuum pressure was released. This forbade the train from moving an inch.

This incident took place eighteen minutes after the presence of the train at the station.

The ones pelting the passengers, at full pelt with brickbats burning with their own scorching rage was the mob. They engulfed the train. Like their religion their cries too were Islamic. The slogans were spontaneous just like the crimes they were committing. However, in peerless terms they were committing sin not crime. The raging fire was fueled by the rage of the mob. They were shouting to save their non-violent religion by employing violence. The slogans were — "Burn all the Hindus!" and "Thrash the Hindus! Islam is in danger! Hindus ought to be minced and burnt!" The speakers were the 'speakers'. The message was well propagated. The targets of the stones shut the windows and portes but they were demolished in no time. The pilgrims tried all possible measures to save themselves using the burning tattered rags and

light bulbs. Nevertheless the attempts proved futile. Indeed a predator has nothing much to be anxious about (not even that he would be punished later), it is the prey who has to become the object of fear. Fifty-nine people lost their lives in less than fifty-nine minutes. The death toll was heavy. The maimed guild consisted of twelve wriggling children (the future of India) and twenty-six women (the real rulers as they are the ones who give birth to the rulers). The then twelve future citizens of India are now a talk of the 'old' past.

As the fire raged the firemen reached the spot. Although they were the predators of fire they suffered like preys. It seemed as if they were making bricks without straw. In their malignant exasperation the mob raised stockades on the way of the 'Predators of Fire'. The fire brigade met a huge mob with a Congress worker of Godhra Nagarpalika, Haji Bilal. Now, the confrontation was more of a conflict. Haji Bilal, the chairman of the Vehicle Committee, was accused of being the reason for the destruction of the tender, the windpanes and fenetres.

The fire brigade ran out of the troublezone only to find the prey dead. Vijay Singh, one of the firemen, happened to witness a pitiable woman at a window of the carriage. Her destitution invoked pity. The heat being wild and too much scorching it took thirty minutes to douse the raging flames. The condition being serious forty-five survivors who had had a narrow escape were taken to hospital.

Like Hanumanji, the devout devotee of Ram, doused all the impediments coming along his way to know the whereabouts of Sita ji, the firemen too overcame the obstacles to save the victims.

The police were, on the other hand, speechless at the grotesque occurrence. They just shot some projectiles. A female victim requested them for help in exchange for her jewellery. The police are supposed to be the protectors of the people for the sake of whom they can ever sacrifice their own lives. However, there they were 'gaining' a victim's jewellery as nobble. What sort of epoch are we dwelling in!

Another severe attack was made at 11:30 a.m. The Railway Protection Force neutralised it.

It is the law of nature that bad news spreads earlier than good news. It was status quo. Chet

Narendra, who was the chief Minister after Keshubhai, won a by-election from the Rajkot II electoral division. The majority with which he won was 14000. The major reason for the not so enormous majority was the disagreement of the VHP and the Bajrang Dal, and they didn't even acquiesce in campaigning for Narendra. Another possible reason could be the ill-fame of Patel's governance.

The Bharatiya Janata Party was not a very eager supporter of the establishment of the Ram temple at Ayodhya at least according to the figment of VHP's imagination. And personally, Narendra himself was not a part of the andolan.

As for now, the majority was neither a fluster nor a fillip. It was flux. The impasse situation still didn't attack the BJP that was no longer fledged.

As hours passed Narendra learnt about the holocaust in Godhra. The first thing that struck the peremptory Chief Minister's mind was the prorogation of the state assembly that was to be held that day. Nevertheless the procrastination was tough to be made as the Finance Minister had to introduce the budget. So, he couldn't countermand it.

After the budget speech the Chief Minister personally left for Godhra. A statewide alert was issued to law implementation sectors, thus cancelling the leave.

Narendra went by an aircraft as the helicopter was not available at the moment. The ONGC was requested to lend the helicopter. The corporation only acquiesced as it didn't want to permit VIPs to travel by the single-engine helicopter.

But the egghead had to make his egress anyway. Narendra arrived at the spot. He could only see it as egregious. The egalitarian had not even imagined the electrifying situation to be that serious. He had already posted the Minister of State and some senior officers in the matin.

The officers reported the negatively sinew situation. Who could smile a simpering and sizzling smile then?

Narendra sensed that the profligate violence was an example of terrorist crime and not of the supposed communal violence. The order for the implementation of curfew was issued in Godhra as well as in twenty-eight other villes. The police didn't sit silently. Narendra commanded the district magistrates, police commissioners etc. to resume directing the rising situation from their own centres.

Later on the egalitarian learnt that the Vishwa Hindu Parishad had planned and implemented a get-together. The amiss thing was, in the presence of a yucky corollary. The wrath bandits would place the coronet of Hinduism on the highest possible place and the sim would start. They would play with others' lives as if they were mere yo-yos. And then anybody could place the substitute of the yttrium. The situation wasn't going to be the result of a 'cozenage' but that of something so inevitable. After skirting all the convicted areas would the 'non-profanation' profane the other side. The

prodigal skirmish would then be prolonged. There was no sort of sine die taking place. The time-to-time schedule was sure to reach the time — unless and until any obstruction took place. The wild singing would beget wild corollary. Sinisters, from both the sides, would begin the last battle pronto. They were, qualmlessly, not at all skanky. They could, in other words, be called the 'Martyrs of religion'. But the serious situation wasn't a sitcom to be sure, and Narendra worked on the devastating situation.

Narendra worked with the speed of mind and requested the Indian Government to release quatre companies of the RAF — Rapid Action Force as well as *dix* companies of CPMF — Central ParaMilitary Forces. The orders had been placed ere 8 p.m. in Godhra ante Narendra journeyed back to Gardhinagar. The Chief Minister reached the designated destination on 27 February after approximately two and a half hours of the sending of the request.

It was 28 February. The Manchester of India's police force of 6000 had been stanced. Narendra

took other steps to curb the situation. The situation spread like wildfire.

Narendra's industrious work done to end the tragedy was more than enough, however, the alien powers have not accepted it till date.

Debates have continued for the 'past many generations'. The 2002 riots affected 20% of the districts in Gujarat. The most notable thing is that the coxcomb chief Ministers of the adjacent states of Rajasthan, Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh when informed of the crazy situation and requested for help turned their backs to him craftily. They were so crabby. They behaved like crags with crevices. They gave credence to the situation faithlessly. It seemed as if they wouldn't accede to the request without getting the credential. Their credibly credible brush-off was not much unexpected. If it was not a creosote it wasn't a thorn either. Narendra wouldn't cripple anyway. He had crammed the mantra of success by heart. That was creditable! How could his success be cramped by crepitations?

By 12 April 2002 Narendra had shaped his mind. He wanted to resign from the post of Chief Minister. 12 April was when the BJP National Executive planned to meet at Panaji in Goa. The day was more or less the turning point of his life.

In the assembly Narendra discernibly spoke that he wanted to resign from post. Even in his peroration he highlighted the same. He made it so clear that even the people who were pernickety became content. Narendra couldn't bear the humiliation being given to the innocuous who hadn't even perpetrated. The fact per se was cause for resignation. Dissonance arose. There were no dissidents but people who were tasting the persimmon in his reign. The resignation of Narendra would definitely prove to be pernicious for the party. With the dismissal of the resignation the Goa session came to an end.

Narendra, since his childhood, firmly and grimly believed in the democracy of India. He didn't lose his credulity for democracy even then and decided to dissolve the government,

thus placing his future in the hands of democracy.

On 24 September 2002 Islamic terrorists perniciously attacked Gujarat. At 4:30 the perps began hurling projectiles at the families relishing the beauty of nature in the Sahajanand Van. The profligate 'profanity' (showing disrespect for human religion) led to the death of twenty-nine people.

The perps got what they deserved. They were shot dead. Thereafter skirmishes ceased to exist.

Qualmlessly, there are times in our lives when we just feel like crumpling the mauvais and restarting the race with the application of a creosote. There are times in our lives when we have to understand that the past is precisely what it is and can't be changed but the story that is retold can be altered and by doing so we can alter the future.

De novo, novel elections were the creosote of Narendra. The wound which required the creosote was his concupiscence to know the people's configuration. It seemed as if he

wanted to retread in a desultory sort of way. It couldn't be wilful as the feint was bold and he had mused well. It was an artificial flair but not an aversion in any case.

The time of the building of Gujarat without shenanigans was known to the Omniscient God alone.

In the seventh month of 2002, years and years after he had been co-opted, he dissolved the state assembly. Mais you know what opponents are like. A coppice with the CEC, James Michael Lyngdoh à la tête was sent.

Negotiations followed at the end of which elections were destined to take place in December the same year. Narendra, ad interim, ignited the flame of the yatra-candle in the form of the Jagannath Rath yatra. Also, shobha Yatra was initiated on Shree Krishna Janmashtami day.

Inter alia were the 'La fête de Ganesh' and the 'Gaurav' which means 'Pride' or 'Gujarat Pride' in compliance with the state.

On 24 September, 7 days after the fifty-second birthday of Narendra Modi, the Akshardham Temple terrorist attack came into being mais the Gaurav Yatra went on remine contradicente after a recess of 10 days. It seemed to be like the way the former slump in business had been somewhat healed. Even the recession in myriad factors had been brought to its fulfilment as the Gaurav Yatra commenced with renewed vigour and energy.

The assembly elections proved to be a benediction for the BJP as the party secured a whooping 126 and secured a legislative majority. It portrayed the fact that the people wanted Narendra. The 'heavy diadem' was placed on Narendra on 22 December. The venue was the Sardar Patel Stadium - named after the Iron Man of India. The Super Man of India was crowned in the stadium of the Iron Man of India. The requisite oath was taken. The words were spoken with such unraveling thunder that it seemed as if the clouds were precipitating. The words didn't limit themselves to just being spoken but they were also brought into effect. A notable aspect of the oath ceremony was the presence of Atal Bihari Vajpayee.

During the administration of Narendra the 'Rule of Law' was implemented and rules were made not to be broken. An important pre-2002 election marked Narendra's solemn and authentic decision to divert the direction of the waters from the 'watery' River Narmada to the relatively dry Sabarmati. Although its implementation was tough as it was an inter-state project the Super Man with his supervisions easily made the problems lick the dust.

It was the same Super man who was once a super child. And forsooth a look back at his childhood reveals he had the makings of a peerless leader.

The following incident happened when he was six years old. An inter-school kabaddi match was organised at BN High School. There were two teams, one of which had comparatively younger players. The teammates requested him to plan a way to defeat the other team. Narendra devised the plan. He watched and marked the moves of the rival team. He observed their way of fighting, their ways of attacking and defending. Then he compared the moves with

those of the younger team. He found out the defects and told the younger team about the shortcomings and the way to remove them. The team won because of his strategy.

And, Narendra employed his strategy in converting the 'Urban Middle-class Voters' party' into the 'Urban and Rural Voters' party'. He adopted the rivals' social justice agenda.

Narendra used to employ his strategies not only for the sake of victory but also for propagating justice and values.

Once as a child Narendra climbed up a tree. He did this not for fun but for liberating a bird entangled in the strings of a kite. He climbed up the tree with a razor in hand to cut the bonds and allow the bird to fly high and live its life as life in bondage and captivity is no life. He, an altruistic child who risked his own life for the sake of the bird's impunity. And the trait is evinced by his approbation for a surgical strike against Pakistan when the outbreak of a war possessed equal probability.

Narendra has absolutely transformed the railways. He has changed the image of the railways as filthy vehicles in the same way as he altered the image of the BJP.

The possible reason for this undertaking could be his life on the railway station.

Another incident reflects how Narendra reacted to social evils in his childhood. He taught the world both tolerance and universal acceptance belongs to the religion which has Narendra compiled a play titled 'Peelu Phool'. He wrote the play when he was left emotionally overwhelmed at the sight of a priest rejecting an untouchable woman. The plight of an untouchable woman who had no access to the place where God, whose eyes see everyone with equal affection, lived was the plot of the play which was staged in school. It was not a farce indeed.

Forsooth, with Narendra's ascendance in the party BR Ambedkar has become a famous icon. He is a good scout with a bleeding heart.

All these incidents symbolically represent the childhood plays of Narendra which are all

relevant to his present endeavours when he is unstoppably endeavouring to make India stronger. He is strengthening the Defence Sector of India. He said, "125 crore people of India take pride in the valour and bravery of its soldiers and security personnel."

The Heart of the Gujaratis

It is quite needless to state that the BJP or rather Narendra rose to power with a full-fledged majority comprising 117 seats out of the absolute 182 seats. Despite the rigorous and rigid attack made by opponents Narendra went on to become the 'Lord of the People's heart'. People wanted him for his iron policies which had literally simulated them to favour him. And here was halcyon Narendra 'throned' like a king. Critics called him a 'Dictator' and his government 'absolute government' but I would rather call him a 'Good Dictator'. Anyway, whether a 'Democratic government's Chief Minister' or a 'Dictator' he was, after all, 'Modi' and seriously that mattered more than any of his epithets. The 'Modi' in him was where the people sought shelter; the epithets mattered to the opponents. The subjects were deaf to remonstrances.

Narendra had made himself not only virtually but also really famous. He became a well-known icon and a celebrated celebrity. But his

mother, Hira Ben couldn't be surpassed in the beauty of joy. She wasn't the mother of a chief Minister. She was the mother of a lovable icon by whose voice lakhs of mothers, sisters and daughters found relief. It was where the depressed moles went in their most depressed hours. Yes, it was the 'Modi' in him that had the power to be the age.

It came to be that the BJP couldn't become a national power in the year 2009. There were a multitude of reasons that made its riding the crest of a wave prolonged. It couldn't be so nice. At the same time Narendra was doing well in Gujarat, really well in fact.

Previously, in early 2003, Narendra had addressed the Non-resident Indian (NRI) assembly making the congregation familiar with his plan to make the novel computer technology advantageous for transparent governance. He also put forth the development policy consisting of five pillars which were: water, energy (or power in understandable terms), people (the subjects), education and security. It's obvious Gujarat had already seen the veiled policies but Narendra's motive was to unveil them. His

'India first' ideology had begun to get shaped with the 'shakti' Plan. The five foundation pillars of the development policy were collectively called 'Panchamrut' that constitute the essentials of 'Dainik puja'. They are: milk, yogurt, clarified butter, honey and sugar. Their amalgamation is known as 'Panch' which means 'five'. The term 'jal shakti' was coined for water resources' development. 'Urja shakti' was the term used for energy resource development. The 'shakti' of 'gyan' or the power of education was 'gyan shakti'. Raksha Shakti refers to safety and security.

Under the Urja shakti Programme the Jyotigram yojna was launched by Narendra in 2003. A favourable factor of the scheme was the reliable supply of electricity to each and every remote rural village. Workers were the greatest beneficiaries. Their skin would no longer get burnt with the scorching heat and their instruments became reliable in the same way as the reliable electricity. Milk-rendering mammals gave milk in abundance. The reason was obvious. There were electric fans to cool them. And, for sure, like us animals too don't like to be perturbed. Who doesn't crave

convenience? Almost all categories of people found it to be advantageous. And it wasn't anything new. The iron policy had to be as hard as iron leaving a great impact on people. How could the iron policy yield the palm?

Children, the future we have in the present, were greatly benedicted. They could utilize the right hours for the purpose of studying and benefit the country in future.

(pillars)

Unquestionably, the Yojna benefitted the other types of shaktis as well including the jal shakti. Approximately 200 hectares of water mains, 11000 towers, one hundred and fifteen million km of pipes and many a reservoir was laid. They encompassed the grid network which acted as the 'Postman of water'.

Wastewater Treatment Plants were planted. And, above all, the scheme made people aware of the value of water as a resource for sustainable development. They were no longer oblivious of the importance of water as a resource and water resource conservation.

Irrigation techniques like drip irrigation and sprinkler systems became popular with the peasants. The former was greatly popularized by the Gujarat Green Revolution Company. If you observe the map of Gujarat you will notice that out of every ten parts (Gujarat as a whole) seven parts are classified as semi-arid or arid. You wouldn't believe it if you were told that the sole state in India to see an increment in its water table is Gujarat!

Ways to accelerate land productivity were brought to the hearing of the peasantry by the Krushi Mahotsav Scheme. Sarcastically, it made the officials retrieve their lost mind when they acquiesced in working dehors even in the summer heat led by an exemplary example. It worked as a 'Mind Retrieval System' for the tie-wearers. Farmers sent soil samples to get the soil checked. The Gujarat farmer no longer worked as a peasant but as a businessman. The value of production, the quality of production and even the kind of production underwent a sharp increment in the standard. Envisioning the need to let the products reach the consumer, the garib kalyan melas (Poor Welfare Fairs) let all the surplus production reach the multitude,

through flea markets at subventionized rates. Through the Sampras Yojna a bait was dropped onto the hook as 60% graceful fish-villages elected their representatives. The bait was the offer of hundred thousand rupees.

The idea of India which imputed its settlement to the saffron, white and green colours could be traced to the broad-level landscape which tucked in the pride of the 'Indian Indian' when the dominant spirit of patriotism hung out as the superb approach. The roads which were built and repaired were connected to the remote villages. They covered a whooping percentage — 98% of the village dwellers — a majestic percentage indeed. With all the upkeep going on, who wouldn't accept the fact that the iron-hard change was because of the superb thoughts of the Super Man who was so solicitous? And who didn't know the Super Man?

Apart from anything else, Gujarat welcomed foreign investors with open hands. It, thus, earned fame as a global settlement. A noteworthy aspect of the Red Tape was the transfer of the Nano Manufacturing Plant of Tata Motors from West Bengal (Singur) to the

land of Bhakti (Sanand) in the year 2008, nearly 50 years after the birth of the great soul.

More than anything else, the evening courts which began in Gujarat eliminated the dereliction of cases bringing into motion, swift judgement. Ex cathedra did the just jury examine the cases and pass the judgement. Justice couldn't be delayed and so couldn't be denied either. Anyway, that was an overwhelming approach. It all too was worthy of the man.

The Gujarat state government also imposed a complete ban on cow slaughter, transportation and sale of beef by amending the Gujarat Animal Preservation Act in 2011. The issue of illegal slaughterhouses running in the state will also be raised by the BJP government there. Gujarat BJP spokesman Bharat Pandya stated that the government is committed to save cows.

All thanks to Mr. Narendra Modi!

Every history-lover must know that Surat is a richly historical city. Needless to say, it gradually lost its graceful pride.

The 1994 plague incident left deep imprints on the minds of the survivors but the 2006 flood had more to do with the government. The way the 2006 inundation was confronted peeps through the window of the realistic alteration in government's aid.

Surat is the 'La Ville Lumière' of India now. It is the 'La Ville de Kie' of the present. Most of its vehicles run on CNG which is a cleaner fuel.

Birth rate is affected by the health rate, employment rate as well as the settlement rate et al.

With increasing health care the birth rate crops up as the death rate remains fairly low. When parents are employed they bear children knowing that they can manage them.

When they are settled which means everything is favourable they let the lineage progress.

The river system of Surat is enviable. The Waste Water Treatment Plant (WWTP) of Surat is famous all over the world. Its gross Domestic

Product (GDP) was once 'la grande'. It is titled 'La Maison des Vêtements' of India because of the flourishing textile industry.

The Raksha shakti, the power of security exercised its prowess well. Skirmishes and Gujarat are now parallel to each other, they don't intersect.

The Inspiration

The CPU of India

'The Maker of Iron Decisions' for all his iron decisions, iron reforms and iron results was appointed as the chairman (not the man who just sits and relaxes on a chair) of the committee meant for election-campaigning for the Bharatiya Janata Party. He was, thus, BJP's official candidate for Prime-ministership (or in the public's words 'the power of real taste'). The 2014 Lok sabha election was going to be the iron turning point of the life of the people and, of course, Mr. Narendra. The future of the subjects so well-connected to Narendra was going to be shaped. Rajnath Singh became the new Chairman for election campaign.

The shape of India which constitutes six major physiographic divisions was now fated to be politically and physiographically shaped by the dominant physiographic elections inviting a physiographic democracy under a physiographic party to be challenged by other parties for the claim of a physiographic land inhabited by physiographic people. With great

punctiliousness Indians hate and detest arrogance and self-praise. Their simplicity is, paradoxically, physiographic. That's why India is unique and will always be. It is a sweet place and no one has the right to annihilate its sweetness. Bharat-varsha is a place no true Indian would like to leave. It is a land where even bitter truths are delivered as wry lessons, softened by the flavour of humour. The level-headed Indians can differentiate between good and bad, it's only the external circumstances that force them to be externally evil. And the 2014 elections - meant to shape the shape of Indians - would also shape Mr. Narendra, an Indian in thought, word and action. There is no need of placing the punctuation mark, comma after 'thought' and before 'word' because they are so diffused in the context of Mr. Narendra. He speaks what he thinks. That's his simplicity - the hallmark of a true Indian.

Opinionated zealots had many things to point out. Their pointing fingers paint the democracy in India — functionally the largest in the world. It's the view of democracy where the rulers and the ruled are treated as one, not as separate or distinct entities, that's why India has remained

one ever since the time of independence. Who would not pride himself on being the citizen of the country which has taught the environs the meaning of tolerance? Who would not pride himself on being the resident of the country which stands on the epigraph of non-violence not only to humans but to animals as well? Who could be greater than the native of the country where people were greater inviting hosts than invitees? Who could know the importance of customs and art better than the naturalized member of the country where clairvoyant facts revealed the presence of a clandestine intrauterine baby whose domicile would be marked by the presence of a tilak on the occasion of Rakshabandhan? And forsooth the intrepidity of Indians couldn't be blasphemed by the most hard-hearted or stingy blasphemer. Who would inveigh against the democratic country which had to become a democratic nation?

The date of the election approached. Money bags made India along with bulky promises by bulky leaders and the promises couldn't be evaporated fully — you know they were 'bulky'. Nice-looking leaders had fierce-looking skulls

buried in the heart not in the mind which longed for power. Even while snoring, the democratic ideals would push the chair. The voters had votes and the promise-makers had promises to make. Tickets were distributed amongst suitable and winnable family members. The power of money alone would soar high.

Promises on paper would remain bits of power after the elections. But this was an election for a change although some factors from the list above continued to exist exactly as every usual cell has nucleus, cytoplasm and plasma membrane. But this time the organelles had to change. Change is the law of nature and it is also the law of India.

And a remarkable change appeared — Mr. Modi became Mr. Prime Minister! That was the 'burst of the monsoon' so good and so stunning, stunning because the BJP had jumped into the sweet fray after the 'booming years' of Congress leadership. This exemplified the fact that in a democracy there is no permanent loser, so, of course, no permanent winner. It was the Transition season for the Congress. India was

shaped in a unique shape - a shape that had to last long.

The then President Mr. Pranab Mukherjee administered the oath of office of the Prime Minister to Mr. Modi at the swearing-in ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhawan on 26 May 2014. With the enthronement came people's expectations. The diadem was placed on the head which was destined to be the aide of the people. The time had ascended, the age had descended and Modi had come.

On 1 July 2017 Modiiji enforced GST (Goods and Services Tax) — The 'Good and Simple Tax'. It affected the economy and people's lives. Nothing could be done illegally now. At least that was the intent. It established the 'can't do anything illegally' (transaction) rule when the 'shouldn't do anything illegally' was prevalent. Many jewelers suffered from heavy losses, first because of demonetisation and then because of the imposed GST. It was the money they 'had to pay' but the thing was that it 'had to' be used for the poor, the animals and the destitute.

Despite being dissatisfied by Demonetisation and GST why did people love BJP? The answer was simple — The BJP was the party of the Bharatiyas, it was a party for the Bharatiyas and most importantly, it was a party by the Bharatiyas, so Bharatiyas could call it their own. But then, even possessions are forsaken when they repel. This brings to light the fact that the people affected knew that the money they paid as taxes would be used for the benefit of the 'backward'. This gave them a strong sense of satisfaction, and contentment matters more than wealth. And it really mattered more in this case as well.

But the businessmen and the poor were not the only ones who liked him because the fifteenth Prime Minister of India didn't do everything only for them.

The policy of 'Triple Talaq', as it is commonly called, proves this point. The Muslim women of India were the greatest beneficiaries of this advantageous step. Essentially, it didn't affect the Muslim women alone but also the women who belonged to non-Islamic faiths for they liked the way Modi was sensitive to the rights

of women. The SC (Supreme Court) declared instantaneous talaq or uttering the word 'talaq' thrice in one go as unconstitutional. Exclusively meant for the public good, the policy of lightening every house was shaped by the BJP government.

Under the Jan Dhan yojna he has got the accounts of the poor opened at zero balance. They have availed the benefit directly. The poor women have been given gas connections free of cost under the Ujjawala scheme.

The debt of the poor peasants has been remitted. The remittance has been followed by the program of rendering ₹6000 p.a. to the poor peasants.

Moreover, all villages under Pradhan Mantri Adarsh Gram yojna (PMAGY) will attain modern village status by 2022 and the implementation channels have started their job. The dream project of Modiji (the formation of 100 smart cities) is now going to be a reality.

It shows that he is not remiss as the opponents, including Rahul Gandhi, call him.

The fifteenth one in the line of Prime Ministers says that the project to build the roads is not to run the vehicles but to run the prosperity.

The government will surely achieve malnutrition-free and poverty-free India one day.

The BJP government in Gujarat has enacted a law with the provision of life sentence for those found guilty of cow slaughter making it the first state in the country to do so. The tenure for imprisonment according to the latest provision is the largest in the country. The fine is worth rupees five lakhs. (In 2011 the amendment was done on Chhatri Navratri)

The year 2017 proved to be unique. 19 March saw the rise of a controversial hardline advocate of Hindutva Yogi Aditya Nath, a saffron robed priest, who at the time of the swearing-in ceremony (for the post of the Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh), swore to eradicate all the butcherhouses. He tried his level best to ban the consumption of non-vegetarian viands in the

pilgrimage spots - Mathura, Vrindavan, Goverdhan and Barsana.

The people of cine world, sports' world, peasants, labourers, soldiers, politicians - everybody has joined the Swachh Bharat movement. Premier Narendra Modi said a toilet keeps the dignity of the house up to the mark. Modiji laid the foundation stone of a toilet at a village in Varanasi himself. Slogans like 'Clean City, Green City: This is my Dream City.' have been written in calligraphy on hoardings. Reports state that more than crore toilets have been built under this movement. Besides, the construction of toilets has caused masons to be employed, and has saved more than three lakh lives.

Kailash Mansarovar highlighted the great possibilities of the development of the tourism industry in Uttar Pradesh. The Kailash Mansarovar Bhawan in Uttar Pradesh will be made the centrepiece of accelerating the growth rate of tourism. This will decelerate the speed of unemployment.

Uttar Pradesh will be made a Metro Corporation. 6 novel highways will brighten the face of Lucknow.

As for culprits, they will have to opt for one of two options - death or lifelong imprisonment. More than 450 criminals have been encountered in Uttar Pradesh.

Under the governance of the BJP government Anti-Romeo Squads have been built to safeguard women against stalkers made to swear off such absurd activities.

A copy-free environment has been ensured during the time of examinations.

Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao, and Aapki Sakhi as well as Rani Laxmi Bai and Asha Jyoti Kendra are some of the many projects launched by the Women Welfare Department during his Prime-Ministership.

Acid attack victims will be provided financial assistance. The expense of their plastic surgery etc. will be borne by the Mahila Samman Kosh. The notable aspect here is that in lieu of naming

it 'Mahila Sahayata Kosh' the BJP government has named it 'Mahila Samman Kosh'. This highlights the way in which the BJP government considers the fact that women should gain monetary relief not with a sense of begging but as their right as citizens. This highlights the party's broad-mindedness and far-sightedness.

Even our foreign policy is based on the substratum of tolerance. Modi ji, has hoisted the flag of India all over the world by making the world recognise India as 'Viskhwaguru'. Premier Modi ji is improving the image of India in the eyes of foreigners. This has made foreigners like India. India is one of the best tourist attractions on earth.

The flamboyance of India has been elevated in the eyes of the foreigners.

In the program 'Man Ki Baat', Modi ji listens to the ideas of the children regarding myriad issues. The way he triggered the surgical strike invaded the heart of every Indian. It made the world recognise 21 June as International Day of

yoga. Modiji knows English, Hindi, Gujarati
and what not.

The Conscious Chowkidaar

It is sometimes said that fate snatches the things most dear to us from us and hands over the things which aren't our priorities.

Surely, no powerful person would like power to be snatched from him but then there are others who are really crazy about it and can resort to anything (even violence) for its attainment. Frankly, it seems like they're here to score political points rather than to negotiate in good faith. But Fate is also crazy about snatching power from the hands of such people. Development is Modiji's priority. and his priority lays the red carpet for other achievements.

Modiji called himself Chowkidar Narendra Modi. It portrays his humility — the way he likes his place as the 'eternal servant' of India and the guardian of the Chowk. He calls himself not the Prime Minister but the Prime Sevak of the country.

Not only this, he also named himself 'Chaiwala' upholding the principle of Indian democracy that even a 'Chaiwala' can become the Prime Minister of India.

Five years passed thus. The democracy of India called for elections. As soon as Indians learnt the news of novel elections it seemed as if the 'good days' of India had finally arrived. Actually, that's the identity of the Modi government.

And Modi returned to power - a roaring success. The government formed was the government of Modi.

The shape of India changed. It had to change.

People, who could be seen rushing to the polling booths for voting for their favourite leaders, saw the result with their own eyes.

A 'chaiwala' had become the Prime Minister of India once again. Modi had returned. Yes, he had returned. How could their own eyes decline them? The golden age had returned. The primeval glory of India had returned. The lost

pride of the 'Indian' had returned. The chowkidar had returned to guard the chowk.

The children were ecstatic. Being unable to speak clearly they were shouting, "Maadi, Maadi!" as loud as they could. They believed that he was the one who would give them everything just like their Maa does. He was an angel in their eyes which always spoke the truth. That was a touching atmosphere.

Markets echoed with echoes like — "Who can defeat Modi? No one on earth."

People love Modi because he loves them and love is toujours reciprocated with love and endearment.

Indeed nothing succeeds like success. Modi had the sweet smell of success. The BJP was a howling success! But the fact is that Modi is not to be affected by success.

Modi is success personified.

At the time of the swearing-in ceremony the Prime Minister was cheered to the echo. Many

echoed what their leader said. Modi promised the Indians that he would fulfil the promising archaic assurances. He promised to live up to the expectations of the Indians. Modi said that it was the people who had decided to have a strong government to strengthen the nation. It was the people who had voted him back to 'service'. He also stated that the government wouldn't stop its good work 'everyone's support, everyone's prosperity, everyone's trust' can heal the wounds of our motherland. Modi wants the young generation to rouse into action. He says that powerful men are meant to work and that politics should be chosen not for becoming something but for doing something.

But sorry, Modi is our only hope. He will have to do a lot more than fulfilling the promises he is entitled to do. We can't lose hope now or we will be doomed.

Kaishraji made his name immortal by helping one Sudama but Modi has to help one hundred and thirty-three crore (and probably more) Sudamas and then imagine the way his name will be written in history.

The greatest noticeable element is that he is the controller of his actions, not the one who is controlled by his actions.

Modiji, will you remain the greatest leader of India or will you become the machiavellian of the macrocosm?

We, Indians, expect more from you than you could expect us to expect from you. And not only we but the entire world is going to have expectations from you.

Thomas Alva Edison bestowed light upon the world. Modiji, will you become the second Edison by endowing the sphere with the light of happiness?

The morning hours belong to those who are capable of counteracting the evil sight of others and prove themselves to the spectators. With the epoch in hand Modi advances on the path of liberating our motherland and the world from the dark forces. The man in him and the leader in him are worth great expectations. His ethereal potency is real, charming and credulous. May that potency further make him

potential! Modi is the world's and the world is Modi's. There is no need for any adjective to describe mother and father.

And no linguist can make a word fit to describe the peerless Modi.

Neither is Modi a party nor a man. Modi is the central part of thoughts reaching which the fragile class people inflate their expectations.

Actually, Modi is not the man of the epoch, the epoch is Modi himself. Modi is the aeon. And Modi means Modi.

The era is Modi... Viraat Modi.

Notes

I will account for the issues with chronology. Events separated by years—and sometimes by more than a decade—are occasionally compressed into a single sequence. The 1969 Ahmedabad communal riots, for example, appear in proximity to the Mandal Commission and the reservation agitations of the early 1980s, although they belong to different political contexts. Likewise, the governments of Madhavsinh Solanki are sometimes conflated, causing the 1980 electoral victory, the 1981 anti-reservation protests, the historic 1985 election, and the subsequent unrest to appear as one continuous episode rather than distinct chapters in Gujarat's political history.

Also, Modi did not suddenly emerge as a senior Gujarat BJP functionary in the mid-1990s; his organisational responsibilities had been steadily expanding since the late 1980s before he eventually assumed national responsibilities..

The discussion of caste politics and reservation also deserves greater nuance. The manuscript

occasionally presents the reservation policy of the Solanki government as the singular cause of Gujarat's unrest. History, however, rarely submits to such simplicity. The KHAM coalition, reservation policies, caste mobilisation, communal tensions, economic anxieties, factional politics and electoral calculations interacted with one another in ways too intricate to be reduced to a single cause. Likewise, the Mandal Commission did not itself create reservations; it was constituted to identify socially and educationally backward classes and recommend measures for their advancement. Its recommendations remained unimplemented until 1990.

The Emergency chapter attributes an unusually expansive role to Narendra Modi. His contribution to the underground organisational network of the RSS in Gujarat is well documented and undoubtedly significant. Nevertheless, the nationwide resistance to the Emergency was the work of countless activists, journalists, students, trade unionists, socialists, Gandhians and opposition leaders across India. The BJP's rise in Gujarat, for instance, was undoubtedly aided by Narendra Modi's

remarkable organisational abilities, but it was also shaped by the decline of the Congress organisation, anti-incumbency, the expansion of the RSS, the leadership of figures such as Keshubhai Patel and Shankersinh Vaghela, demographic changes, municipal successes, and wider ideological shifts within Indian politics.

Several important historical developments also deserve fuller treatment. The Nav Nirman Movement of 1974, the growth of the RSS during the post-Emergency years, the Ram Janmabhoomi movement, the rivalry between Keshubhai Patel and Shankersinh Vaghela, and the distinction between communal and caste-based violence in Gujarat provide essential context for understanding both Modi's political evolution and the transformation of Gujarat's electoral landscape.

References

This manuscript should not be regarded as a definitive work of historical scholarship or as an authoritative record of the events it describes. It was originally shaped largely by family recollections, oral accounts and political memories passed down across generations.

A principal source was our father, Mangal Pandey, who entered political and organisational life at the age of thirteen and later became a longstanding supporter and member of the Bharatiya Janata Party. He was inspired by his father and our grandfather, Late Shri Krishna Ballabh Tiwari who was a non-violent activist in the 1966 *Gau Raksha Andolan* (Anti-Cow Slaughter Agitation) which was a historic mass protest led by saints, sadhus, and various political organizations to demand a nationwide legal ban on cow slaughter. Under Prime Minister Indira Gandhi, this movement escalated into a major national crisis. He suffered from many lathi charge injuries that were inflicted upon the peaceful protesters.

Because the BJP itself was formally established only in 1980, references to Mangal Pandey's earlier political involvement should be understood as participation in the ideological and organisational currents from which the party later emerged. He was associated with the RSS in his youth, participated in political activity during the Emergency of 1975–77 and remained closely connected with the BJP and allied organisations through the party's formative decades.

In 1987, he came into contact with the renowned Hindi poet and satirist Kaka Hathrasi and his comrade, Dr. Virendra Tarun, who bestowed upon him the pen name "Mangal Pandey" in recognition of the patriotic spirit reflected in his poetry, invoking the memory of the Indian revolutionary martyr of the same name. This encouragement inspired him to further cultivate his voice as a patriotic poet. He was subsequently invited to recite poetry at programmes associated with the Bajrang Dal and the Vishwa Hindu Parishad, supporting their public campaigns through poetry and oratory.

During the Ram Janmabhoomi movement, he travelled as a poet and speaker, reciting compositions at public meetings and rallies. Among the hit poems of his was “*Bawre ki bawri ka naam mit jaayega.*” Through such performances, he participated in the wider cultural and political mobilisation surrounding the movement.

He also served as both a firsthand witness to and a participant in Lal Krishna Advani’s Rath Yatra. His poetry took him across India, including Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, Karnataka and Bombay, as well as most other states of the Indian subcontinent. He performed on multiple occasions alongside Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, himself a noted poet and orator, and at times shared platforms with Murli Manohar Joshi and Kalyan Singh. These experiences gave him a close view of the personalities, campaigns and political atmosphere that shaped the rise of the BJP and the Ram Janmabhoomi movement.

In 1993, he founded a monthly publication titled *Adi Sanatan*. The name may be understood as referring to that which is

primordial, ancient and enduring. The periodical was devoted to patriotism, cultural identity and public affairs, and reflected his belief that poetry and journalism could serve as instruments of national awakening.

His recollections of political campaigns, party organisation, poetry gatherings and the leaders he encountered formed an important part of the narrative presented in this book. As with all oral histories, however, these memories may reflect personal experience, political conviction and the passage of time rather than independently verified documentation.

The manuscript also draws upon anecdotes and biographical material from:

Marino, Andy. *Narendra Modi: A Political Biography*. HarperCollins India, 2014.

It is to be noted that memories may change over time, and political events may be remembered differently by those who witnessed or participated in them. Certain passages may consequently reflect personal interpretation, admiration or political perspective rather than independently verified historical fact.

Readers seeking a comprehensive account of the events discussed in this book are encouraged to consult primary records, election data, judicial decisions, official reports, contemporary journalism and scholarly historical works.